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TEST BOOKLET SERIES

**Test Code:
2207****TEST BOOKLET
GENERAL STUDIES
TEST – 7****C****Time Allowed : Two Hours****Maximum Marks : 200****INSTRUCTIONS**

1. IMMEDIATELY AFTER THE COMMENCEMENT OF THE EXAMINATION, YOU SHOULD CHECK THAT THIS TEST BOOKLET *DOES NOT* HAVE ANY UNPRINTED OR TORN OR MISSING PAGES OR ITEMS, ETC. IF SO, GET IT REPLACED BY A COMPLETE TEST BOOKLET.
2. ENCODE CLEARLY THE TEST BOOKLET SERIES CODE **A, B, C** OR **D** AS THE CASE MAY BE IN THE APPROPRIATE PLACE IN THE ANSWER SHEET.
3. You have to enter your Roll Number on the Test Booklet in the Box provided alongside this line. *DO NOT* write *anything else* on the Test Booklet.
4. This Test Booklet contains 100 items (questions). Each question is printed both in **Hindi** and **English**. Each item comprises four responses (answers). You will select the response which you want to mark on the Answer Sheet. In case you feel that there is more than one correct response, mark the response which you consider the best. In any case, choose **ONLY ONE** response for each item.
5. You have to mark all your responses **ONLY** on the separate Answer Sheet provided. See directions in the Answer sheet.
6. All items carry equal marks.
7. Before you proceed to mark in the Answer Sheet the response to various items in the Test Booklet, you have to fill in some particulars in the Answer Sheet as per instructions sent to you with your admission certificate.
8. After you have completed filling in all your responses on the Answer Sheet and examination has concluded, you should hand over to the Invigilator *only the Answer Sheet*. You are permitted to take away with you the Test Booklet.
9. Sheets for rough work are appended in the Test Booklet at the end.
10. **Penalty for wrong answers:**
THERE WILL BE PENALTY FOR WRONG ANSWERS MARKED BY A CANDIDATE IN THE OBJECTIVE TYPE QUESTION PAPERS.
 - (i) There are four alternatives for the answer to every question. For each question for which a wrong answer has been given by the candidate, **One-Third** of the marks assigned to that question will be deducted as penalty.
 - (ii) If a candidate gives more than one answer, it will be treated as a **wrong answer** even if one of the given answers happens to be correct and there will be same penalty as above to that question.
 - (iii) If a question is left blank, i.e., no answer is given by the candidate, there will be no **penalty** for that question.

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1. With reference to the Vijayanagara Empire, which one of the following travellers is **not** correctly matched to his country of origin?

Traveller **Country**

- (a) Nicolo de Conti : Italy
(b) Abdur Razzak : Persia
(c) Afanasii Nikitin : Spain
(d) Duarte Barbosa : Portugal

2. Consider the following statements with reference to Ajanta cave paintings:

1. These caves have both mural and fresco types of painting.
2. Tempera style has been used in it.
3. These paintings depict the life of Buddha, vegetation and unique hairstyle for female figures etc.

Which of the statements given above are correctly matched?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

3. Which of the following ministries has launched Project BOLD?

- (a) Ministry of Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises
(b) Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare
(c) Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change
(d) Ministry of Tribal Affairs

4. Consider the following statements:

1. Under Mansabdari System, the army contingent of nobles consisted of a mixed group of Mughal, Pathan, Hindustani and Rajputs.
2. The category of Mansab's ranks was rigid.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

5. What was the term used for heads of the craftsman guilds?

- (a) Sarthavaha (b) Sreshthi
(c) Jetthaka (d) Bhandagarika

6. The term 'Harit Dhara' was recently in the news. Consider the following statements regarding it:

1. Harit Dhara can cut down cattle methane emissions by more than 50%.
2. Harit Dhara has been made from tannin-rich plant-based sources.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

7. Which of the following were the observations made about the Mughal Rule by François Bernier ?

1. Absence of land as private property.
2. An affluent middle class was present in Indian society.
3. Artisans were impoverished as they made no profits on their work.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) 1 and 3 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1, 2 and 3 (d) 1 and 2 only

8. Consider the following statements about the Mauryan Empire:

1. Reference to mahamattas incharge of women welfare can be found in the fifth rock edict.
2. References of the relief measures adopted during the Magadha famine are found in the Nigali Sagar inscription.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2



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9. With reference to the NIPUN Bharat Programme, which of the following statements is/are **not** correct?

1. It aims to cover the learning needs of children in the age group of 9 to 14 years.
2. This mission has been launched under the aegis of the centrally sponsored scheme of Rashtriya Madhyamik Shiksha Abhiyan (RMSA).

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

10. Consider the following statements:

1. The highly polished nature of the Ashokan pillars highlight the Achaemenian influence.
2. The Didarganj Yakshi sculpture found in Bihar belongs to the Mauryan period.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

11. With reference to the Indian Council of Cultural Relations, consider the following statements:

1. It was established by Jawahar Lal Nehru in 1950.
2. One of its objectives is to foster and strengthen cultural relations and mutual understanding between India and other countries.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

12. With reference to Tillari Conservation Reserve, which of the following statements is **not** correct?

- (a) The Karnataka government declared the Tillari forest area in the Dodamarg and Sawantwadi range as a conservation reserve area.

(b) Tillari conservation reserve is located near the border of Maharashtra, Goa and Karnataka.

(c) The 29.53 sq. km Tillari Conservation Reserve area connects the Mhadei sanctuary in Goa and Bhimgad in Karnataka.

(d) Tillari reserve has semi-evergreen forests, tropical moist deciduous forests, and a number of unique trees, butterflies, and flowers.

13. Which of the following pairs of terms and their meanings are correctly matched?

1. Samantas – A king who has been defeated but his kingdom has been restored
2. Eccoru – Obligation of villagers to provide food to state officials
3. Vellalar – Tenant farmers
4. Ulukudi – Land owning farmers

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) 1, 2 only
(b) 3 and 4 only
(c) 1, 2 and 3 only
(d) 2, 3 and 4 only

14. With reference to the 'Conjugal Rights' which was seen recently in news, consider the following statements:

1. These rights are recognised by both personal laws and criminal laws.
2. The provisions of Conjugal Rights have their origin in India.
3. Recently these rights are challenged on the ground that it violates the fundamental right to privacy

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3



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15. Consider the following statements about UDISE+ 2019-20:

1. As per this report, the Gross Enrolment Ratio at all levels of school education has improved in 2019-20 compared to 2018-19.
2. It says that the Pupil-Teacher Ratio (PTR) has improved at all levels of school education.
3. It helps measure the education parameters from classes 1 to 12 in government and private schools across India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

16. Consider the following statements about the Satavahanas:

1. Their official language was Sanskrit.
2. Satvahana king Gautamiputra Satkarni is famous for the Hathigumpha inscription.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

17. With reference to the medieval history of India, the term 'Nastaliq' is related to

- (a) Calligraphy (b) Shahjahan Arc
(c) Charbagh garden (d) Poetic style

18. With reference to the "Last Ice Area" that was in the news recently, which of the following statements are correct?

1. It is a part of Antarctica's ice.
2. It has started melting earlier than the scientists had expected.
3. The area is used by penguins extensively for their survival.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 and 3 only (b) 1, 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 2 only (d) 2 and 3 only

19. Recently, which of the following has set up a New and Emerging Strategic Technologies (NEST) division to deal with security implications of 5G, AI?

- (a) Ministry of External Affairs
(b) NITI Aayog
(c) Ministry of Science and Technology
(d) Prime Ministers Office

20. With reference to the Rashtrakutas, consider the following statements:

1. Kavirajamarga, the first Kannada book on poetics, was written by the Rashtrakuta king Amoghvarsha.
2. Rashtrakutas king patronised Shaivism and Vaishnavism only.
3. The rock-cut Shiva temple at Ellora was built by Rashtrakuta king Krishna I.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1 and 2 only

21. With reference to Rudreswara Temple that was widely heard in the news recently, which of the following statements is **not** correct?

- (a) The temple was constructed in 1213 AD.
(b) It was built by Recharla Rudra, a general of Hoysala king Ganapati Deva.
(c) It is also known as the Ramappa temple, after the sculptor.
(d) The temple rests on a foundation that uses sandbox technology.

22. With reference to the Pala Ruler, consider the following statements:

1. The pala rulers had cultural relations with Tibet.
2. Dharmapala established both Nalanda and Vikramshila University.
3. Pala rulers extended patronage to Buddhism, Shaivism and Vaishnavism.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 2 only (b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3



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23. Consider the following statements:

1. Kushanas were the first to introduce gold coins in India.
2. The satrap system of administrative governance was introduced in India by the Indo-Greeks.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

24. Consider the following statements about the 'Right to Repair' movement:

1. The goal of the movement is to get companies to make spare parts, tools and information on how to repair devices available to customers and repair shops.
2. The Right to Repair electronics also allows consumers to modify their own electronic devices for other purposes.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

25. With reference to the Dhrupad form of classical music, consider the following statements:

1. It has been mentioned in the Natyashastra.
2. Swami Haridas and Tansen were masters in Dhrupad form.
3. Dhrupad includes use of sanskrit syllables and is of temple origin.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

26. With reference to the tradition of caves in western India, which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

Type of Caves	Example
1. Apsidal Vault Roof Chaitya Halls	– Ajanta Caves
2. Apsidal vault roof pillarless hall	– Thanale Caves
3. Flat roof quadrangular hall	– Mahakali Caves

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1, 2 and 3 (d) 3 only

27. Consider the following statements:

1. Build Back Better World (B3W) is an initiative of the G20 countries.
2. B3W intends to help narrow the \$40+ trillion infrastructure gap in the developing world by 2035.
3. The B3W is an elaboration of the Blue Dot Network (BDN).

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

28. With reference to the Moon's wobble effect, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It is termed as a cyclic shift in the Moon's orbit.
2. The Moon's wobble causes a change in the appearance of light coming from the Moon.
3. Moon's wobble effect has an amplifying effect over tides in its complete cycle.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

29. With reference to the Jajmani System, consider the following statements:

1. The Jajmani system ensured economic as well as occupational security to the service provider.
2. The Jajmani system was an economic arrangement between families of different castes by which one family exclusively performs certain services for the other.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2



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30. With reference to the Kapu community, consider the following statements:

1. Kapus are primarily an agrarian community.
2. Kapus are believed to have migrated from the Gangetic plains thousands of years ago.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

31. Consider the following statements about leather puppetry:

1. Reference to leather puppetry can be found in the Mahabharata.
2. Tholu Bomalatta is a form of leather puppetry famous in Tamil Nadu.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

32. Which of the following temples belonged to the Chola Dynasty?

1. Brihadisvara Temple
2. Airavatesvara Temple
3. Meenakshi Temple
4. Virupaksha temple
5. Shore Temple at Mamallapuram

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 1, 2 and 4 only
(c) 1, 4 and 5 only (d) 1, 2, 4 and 5 only

33. Consider the following statements:

1. 'Right to be Forgotten' falls under the purview of an individual's right to privacy.
2. 'Right to Privacy' is a fundamental right in India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

34. With reference to the reforms undertaken during the reign of Akbar, consider the following statements:

1. He introduced secular subjects such as geometry and history in education.
2. He also took steps for the legalisation of Widow remarriage.
3. The sale of wine and spirits was restricted during his rule.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1, 2 and 3
(b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 2 only
(d) 2 only

35. With reference to the Village Panchayats during the Mughal Rule, consider the following statements:

1. The post of headmen or muqaddam was hereditary in nature.
2. The panchayat derived its funds by imposing taxes on commerce and agriculture within the village.
3. Panchayats had the authority to levy fines and inflict punishment like expulsion from the community.

Which of the statements given above is/are **not** correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 3 only
(c) 2 only
(d) 2 and 3 only

36. With reference to Dholavira, which of the following statements is **not** correct?

- (a) It is the first site of the Indus Valley Civilisation in India to get the UNESCO world heritage site tag.
- (b) It was discovered in 1968 by archaeologist Jagat Pati Joshi.
- (c) It has a fortified citadel, a middle town and a lower town with walls made of mud bricks.
- (d) It was a hub of manufacturing jewellery made of shells and semi-precious stones.



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37. With reference to administration in Delhi Sultanate, consider the following statements:

1. Ariz-i-Mumalik was the head of the department of Military.
2. Ariz-i-Mumalik was also the commander in chief of the army.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

38. Consider the following statements with reference to Jayasimha Siddharaja:

1. He built the temple of Rudra Mahakal in Sidhpur.
2. He provided patronage to famous Jain scholar Hemchandra.
3. He built famous Lakshmana temple in Khajuraho.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 2 only (d) 1 and 3 only

39. Information-Monitoring, Evaluation and Social Audit (I-MESA) is an initiative of which of the following ministries?

- (a) Ministry of Women and Child Development
(b) Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment
(c) Ministry of Information and Broadcasting
(d) Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation

40. Which of the following pairs of Ashtha-Pradhan of Shivaji are correctly matched?

1. Sar-i-Naubat – Military commander.
2. Panditarao – Master of ceremonies.
3. Sumanta – Charities and religious administration.

Select the correct answer using the code below:

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 1 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1 and 3 only

41. The literary works 'Digha Nikaya' and 'Mahavastu', give insights into which of the following?

- (a) Different types of occupations
(b) Various sculptures

- (c) Different types of potteries
(d) None of the above

42. Consider the following statements about Near-Surface Shear Layer (NSSL):

1. At NSSL, the rotation profile of the Sun changes sharply.
2. NSSL exists very close to the solar surface, where there is an outward decrease in angular velocity.
3. Understanding NSSL is crucial for the study of several solar phenomena.
4. The theoretical explanation of the existence of an NSSL in the Sun has been given by the scientists of the Indian Institute of Space Science and Technology, Thiruvananthapuram.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only (b) 1, 3 and 4 only
(c) 2, 3 and 4 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

43. Which of the following statements is/are correct about the 'Gross Environment Product (GEP)'?

1. It was first established by the United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP).
2. It includes environmental products and services value only from the natural ecosystem.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

44. With reference to life in the Gupta age, consider the following statements:

1. For the first time, civil and criminal law were clearly defined and demarcated.
2. The most important officers in the Gupta Empire were the Kumaramatyas.
3. Chinese traveler Fa-Hsien visited India during the Gupta period.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct.

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3



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45. Consider the following statements about the latest World Economic Outlook report:
1. The latest edition of the report has cut its 2021 growth forecast for India to 9.5% from 12.5% estimated earlier in April 2021.
 2. The global economy is projected to grow 6.0 percent in 2021 and 4.9 percent in 2022.
 3. The World Economic Outlook report is published by the World Economic Forum.
- Which of the statements given above are correct?
- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3
46. With reference to the history of Medieval India, the term Zawabit refers to
- (a) Tax on Foreign Trade (b) Secular Decree
(c) Drum House (d) Revenue officials
47. Consider the following statements:
1. Harappan site of Lothal is located on Khadir Bet island.
 2. Manda is the northernmost site of Indus Valley Civilization.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2
48. With reference to the Nauka module that was recently sent to the International Space Station (ISS), which of the following is **not** correct?
- (a) It is the biggest space laboratory Russia has launched to date.
- (b) It replaced Pirs, a Canadian module on the ISS.
- (c) Nauka took to the ISS another oxygen generator, a spare bed, another toilet, and a robotic cargo crane.
- (d) Nauka means “science” in Russian.
49. The ideal of ‘Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam’ is originally found in?
- (a) Vishnu Upanishad (b) Garuda Purana
(c) Maha Upanishad (d) Mandukya Upanishad
50. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists:
- | List-I
(Folk Music) | List-II
(State) |
|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| A. Baul | 1. Rajasthan |
| B. Pai Song | 2. Maharashtra |
| C. Maand | 3. West Bengal |
| D. Powada | 4. Madhya Pradesh |
- Code:
- | | A | B | C | D |
|-----|----------|----------|----------|----------|
| (a) | 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 |
| (b) | 4 | 3 | 1 | 2 |
| (c) | 3 | 4 | 2 | 1 |
| (d) | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
51. “GRB 200826A” refers to
- (a) An asteroid moving towards earth
(b) A newly found variant of Coronavirus
(c) A resolution of the United Nations related to Afghanistan
(d) None of the above
52. Which of the statements given below about Chaukhandi Stupa is **not** correct?
- (a) It is located in Sarnath, where Buddha gave his first sermons.
(b) The octagonal tower over Stupa was built by Akbar in 1589 AD.
(c) Chaukhandi Stupa was built by Ashoka during his reign.
(d) It has been declared as ‘Monument of national importance’ by Archaeological Survey of India (ASI).
53. Consider the following statements:
1. Lingayat movement in Karnataka was started by Basavanna.
 2. Lingayats believe in the rebirth and perform funerary rites such as cremation.
 3. The major text of Lingayats is called Ginan.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

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54. Recently, the Reserve Bank of India allowed non-bank payment system providers (PSPs), including prepaid payment instruments (PPI) issuers to participate in the Centralised Processing System (CPS) as direct members.

This decision of the RBI will allow non-banks:

1. Allotment of a separate Indian Financial System Code (IFSC) to non-banks.
2. Opening a current account with the RBI in its core banking system.
3. Membership of Indian Financial Network.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

55. Consider the following statements:

1. Alvars were Shaivite saints whereas Nayanars were Vaishnavite.
2. Andal is the only female Alvar saint.
3. Alvars and Nayanars opposed Buddhism, Jainism and Brahmanical Domination.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

56. With reference to the project I-STEM, consider the following statements:

1. It aims to promote the indigenous development of scientific instruments as well as technical supplies.
2. It had special attention to include startups in the projects.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

57. Consider the following statements about Biotech-PRIDE Guidelines:

1. These Guidelines have been released by the Department of Agriculture and Cooperation, Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare.

2. These guidelines will be implemented through the Indian Biological Data Centre (IBDC).

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

58. Consider the following:

1. Tribhanga Pose
2. Creation of complex geometrical shapes
3. Presentation of duet

Which of the important features given above are of Odissi dance?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) None of the above

59. With reference to the Harappan civilisation, consider the following statements:

1. People of Harappan civilization used a pictographic script which was written left to right.
2. The lower part of the Harappan cities contained granaries and houses for the working people.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

60. Recently India has been included among the top rankers in the Global Cyber Security Index, 2020. Which of the following statements is/are correct in this regard?

1. Digital sovereignty in India has been improved.
2. India's coordination system regarding cyber security is brought under centralized supervision.
3. India secured the first position in the Asia Pacific region.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 only
(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1 and 3 only





61. Match the following pairs:

Tradition	State
1. Thakurai Jatarā	– Rajasthan
2. Khelchawa	– Assam
3. Garia Puja	– Tripura

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- (a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1 and 3 only

62. Which among the following are the sources of information about Janapadas and Mahajanapadas?

1. Vinaya Pitaka 2. Sutta Pitaka
3. Jatakas 4. Upanishads

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only (b) 2, 3 and 4 only
(c) 1, 3 and 4 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

63. With reference to the 'Green Hydrogen', consider the following statements:

1. Green Hydrogen is produced from natural gas.
2. It has been suggested that the use of green hydrogen must be increased to meet the dependency on renewable energy.
3. Currently less than 1% of the total hydrogen produced worldwide is green hydrogen.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1 only

64. With reference to the medieval history of India, consider the following pairs:

Department	Related to
1. Diwan-i-amir-i-kohi	– Agriculture
2. Diwan-i-risalat	– Revenue
3. Diwan-i-insha	– State correspondence
4. Diwan-i-arz	– Religious matters

Which of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only (b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2, 3 and 4 only (d) 2 and 4 only

65. With reference to History of Philosophical thought in India, consider the following statements regarding Vaisheshika School:

1. Vaisheshika school of philosophy developed the atomic theory.
2. They didn't believe in God and that the Law of Karma guide this universe.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

66. With reference to the 'Guindy National Park', which among the following statements is **not** correct?

- (a) It is one of the smallest national parks in India.
(b) It is located inside a city.
(c) It is located in Karnataka.
(d) It is an important site for ex-situ conservation strategy.

67. With reference to Buddhism, the term "Saptatathāgata" refers to which of the following?

- (a) The seven deadly sins
(b) The penance of Gautama Buddha
(c) The previous incarnations of Buddha
(d) The seven universal truths

68. Consider the following:

Sangam Literature	Related to
1. Tolkappiyam	– Grammar and Poetics
2. Tirukkural	– Philosophy
3. Silappatikaram	– Love story

Which of the pairs given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 3 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 2 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

69. With reference to the 'LEAF' Coalition, which was recently in news, consider the following statements:

1. It aims to meet the zero-emission target involving private leadership.
2. It is focused on protecting the Tropical forests.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2





70. With reference to the monkey B virus, which was recently in news consider the following statements:

1. These are neuroinvasive viruses.
2. It is endemic in macaques and cannot infect humans.
3. Moist surfaces are favourable for their longer survival.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 3 only (b) 1, 2 and 3
(c) 2 only (d) 1 and 2 only

71. With reference to Gupta administration, consider the following statements:

1. Provinces were known as Vishayas which were subdivided into districts.
2. Provincial governors, called uparikas, were mostly chosen from among the princes

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

72. With reference to the phenomenon 'Heat Dome', consider the following statements:

1. The phenomenon of Heat Dome is characterised by the high gradient in the ocean temperature.
2. Jet stream helps in the formation of Heat Dome conditions.
3. The year of El-Nino is favourable to the phenomenon of Heat Dome.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

73. Panduranga Mahatmayam is a poetic work in which language?

- (a) Tamil (b) Kannada
(c) Malayalam (d) Telugu

74. With reference to the Vedanta School, consider the following statements:

1. Vishistadvaita considers knowledge to be the main means of attaining salvation.
2. Advaita Vedanta considers Brahma to be without any attributes.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

75. Which of the following statements is/are correct regarding the Gravitational waves?

1. Gravitational waves may be produced due to cross collision between the Neutron Star and Black Hole.
2. Gravitational waves travel at the speed of light.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

76. The term 'Khalisa land' during the Delhi Sultanate period referred to

- (a) Land under the direct control of the Sultan
(b) Lands assigned to officials in lieu of payment for their services.
(c) Land assigned or granted to religious leaders or religious institutions.
(d) None of the above

77. Consider the following statements about Indus Valley Civilization:

1. Double cropping began in the mature Harappan phase.
2. The pottery in the late Harappan phase lacks design and is less bright as compared to the mature phase.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2



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78. With reference to the 'Financial Stability Report (FSR)', which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It is published annually by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI).
2. According to the recent Financial Stability Report, the second wave of COVID-19 has an adverse effect on financial stability.
3. Recent Financial Stability Report reflects the increasing Gross Non-Performing Asset (GNPA) ratio of Scheduled Commercial Banks.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 3 only (d) 2 and 3 only

79. Consider the following statements:

1. It was in the early Vedic period that the post of king became hereditary.
2. Among the tribal assemblies of the Rig Vedic period, women were not allowed to attend vidatha.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

80. With reference to the Manipuri Dance, consider the following statements:

1. This dance was introduced by Rabindranath Tagore in the Shantiniketan.
2. In this dance, there is importance to the facial expression and the face is not covered.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

81. With reference to the recent conservation efforts of the Vultures, which of the following statements is **not** correct?

- (a) Vultures are protected under the Wildlife protection act, 1972.
- (b) Recently, the Vulture Action Plan 2020-30 was launched by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and climate change.

(c) Valmiki Tiger Reserve is one of the strategic protection regions for the vultures.

(d) The Vulture Safe Zone programme is being implemented in 8 places.

82. Consider the following statements:

1. He was one of the Ashtadiggajas.
2. He wrote Manucharitam.

The statements given above refer to which of the following?

- (a) Harihara Raichur (b) Allasani Peddanna
(c) Ibn Battuta (d) Tenali Ramakrishna

83. With reference to the 'Nord Stream 2 Pipeline (NS2P)' project, which was recently in news, consider the following statements:

1. It is an underwater gas pipeline project between Europe and the USA.
2. It will reduce Europe's dependence on Russia for Natural Gas.
3. European Union countries rely on Russia for 40% of their gas needs.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

84. The term 'Marine Plastic' is often seen in the news as a major concern to environmental protection. Which of the following statements is/are correct about marine plastic?

1. Marine plastic can include tiny particles in the range of nanometers.
2. The GloLitter Partnerships Project is launched by IUCN to prevent and reduce marine plastic litter.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2





85. Consider the following statements with respect to the Khaljis in the Delhi Sultanate:

1. Allaudin Khalji had undertaken the market reforms and price control.
2. Alai Darwaza had been built during Khalji dynasty.
3. Land Revenue was collected in both cash and kind.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3 only

86. Consider the following statements:

1. Soma was considered as god of plants during the Rig vedic period.
2. Women goddesses are not found in the Rig vedic texts.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

87. With reference to the newly formed 'Ministry of Co-operation', consider the following statements:

1. It has the main aim of realizing the vision of cooperative federalism.
2. It will help cooperative movements reach up to the grassroots.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

88. Bagru Block Printing is mainly practiced in which of the following states?

- (a) Rajasthan (b) Gujarat
(c) Madhya Pradesh (d) Chattisgarh

89. Arrange the following literary texts in chronological order:

1. Indica by Megasthenes
2. Mahabhasya
3. Sulvasutras
4. Shrautasutras

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

- (a) 1-2-3-4 (b) 4-3-1-2
(c) 3-2-1-4 (d) 4-2-1-3

90. With reference to the 'Authorised Economic Operators (AEO)' programme, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It is related to international supply chain security.
2. Authorised Economic Operators (AEO) status is granted by the World Trade Organisation (WTO).
3. AEO is a voluntary programme.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

91. Consider the following statements about the sculptures in the Indian temples:

1. Sculptures of Dvarpalas or doorkeepers are usually found at the entrance of garbhagriha of nagara temples.
2. The only cave sculpture of a boat in India can be found in Kanheri Cave.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

92. Consider the following statements:

1. In the chalcolithic cultures the life of people was short lived.
2. In the stone age the human settlements are found mostly near the hilly areas.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

93. Recently Lemru Elephant Reserve was seen in the news due to a proposal of reducing its area. Which of the following statements is/are correct in this regard?

1. It has several coal blocks in operation.
2. Recently human-animal conflict has increased in this area.





Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

94. Which of the following was/were the reason(s) for choosing Persian as the official language of the administration by the Mughals?

1. Any Indian language as the official language would have diminished the symbol of the establishment of a new rule in India.
2. The mother tongue of Mughals, Turkish, was not popular in India at that time.
3. Arabic was not chosen as it might have shown some kind of allegiance to the Caliph.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 1 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

95. With reference to Phad paintings, consider the following statements:

1. It is a scroll painting originally from Rajasthan.
2. It depicts exploits of local deities which are often carried from place to place and are accompanied by traditional singers.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

96. Consider the following statements about the 'India Industrial Land Bank (IILB)':

1. It aims to provide information on available land for setting up industrial units.
2. It works as a GIS-based portal.
3. India Industrial Land Bank (IILB) is established by SIDBI.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 3 only

97. With reference to the Gandhara School of Art, consider the following statements:

1. The seated Buddha is always shown in lotus feet posture and a meditative gaze.
2. Buddha images are mostly portrayed with a halo around his head.
3. The dress of the Buddha is realistic with many folds.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?:

- (a) 2 and 3 only (b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1 only

98. With reference to the term 'Antimicrobial Resistance (AMR)', which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Any microorganism except viruses could be Antimicrobial drug Resistance.
2. The misuse of antimicrobials in medicine is one of the major sources of spreading AMR.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

99. With reference to the 'Kisan Sarathi' digital platform, consider the following statements:

1. It is a digital platform to facilitate farmers to get 'right information at right time' in their desired language.
2. Farmers can avail personalised advisories on agriculture and allied areas directly from the respective experts of newly established Farmer Producer Organisations.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

100. With reference to the Chola Empire, consider the following statements:

1. King Rajaraja-I attacked and conquered Kalinga.
2. The King Rajendra-I conquered Srilanka.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2



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(English Version)

ANSWER & EXPLANATION
GENERAL STUDIES
TEST – 07
C
ANSWERS

Q. No.	Answers	Q. No.	Answers	Q. No.	Answers	Q. No.	Answers
1	(c)	26	(c)	51	(d)	76	(a)
2	(d)	27	(b)	52	(c)	77	(b)
3	(a)	28	(a)	53	(a)	78	(c)
4	(a)	29	(c)	54	(d)	79	(d)
5	(c)	30	(c)	55	(b)	80	(a)
6	(b)	31	(a)	56	(c)	81	(b)
7	(a)	32	(a)	57	(b)	82	(b)
8	(d)	33	(c)	58	(a)	83	(c)
9	(c)	34	(a)	59	(d)	84	(a)
10	(c)	35	(a)	60	(b)	85	(a)
11	(b)	36	(c)	61	(c)	86	(a)
12	(a)	37	(a)	62	(d)	87	(b)
13	(a)	38	(a)	63	(c)	88	(a)
14	(c)	39	(b)	64	(b)	89	(b)
15	(d)	40	(b)	65	(a)	90	(c)
16	(d)	41	(a)	66	(c)	91	(b)
17	(a)	42	(a)	67	(c)	92	(c)
18	(d)	43	(d)	68	(d)	93	(c)
19	(a)	44	(d)	69	(c)	94	(d)
20	(c)	45	(a)	70	(a)	95	(c)
21	(b)	46	(b)	71	(b)	96	(b)
22	(b)	47	(b)	72	(a)	97	(a)
23	(d)	48	(b)	73	(d)	98	(b)
24	(c)	49	(c)	74	(b)	99	(a)
25	(d)	50	(a)	75	(c)	100	(d)



1. (c)

Explanation:

- Several travellers visited the Vijayanagar city and wrote about it. Notable among their accounts are those of an **Italian** trader named **Nicolo de Conti**, an ambassador named **Abdur Razzaq** sent by the ruler of **Persia**, a merchant named **Afanasii Nikitin** from **Russia**, all of whom visited the city in the fifteenth century, and those of **Duarte Barbosa**, Domingo Paes and Fernao Nuniz all from **Portugal**, who came in the sixteenth century. **Hence, option (c) is correct.**

2. (d)

Explanation:

- Ajanta cave is group of 29 caves.
- Both mural and fresco paintings have been depicted; tempera style has been used in it.
- These paintings include birds, animals, from Jatak stories, depict the life of Buddha, Vegetation and unique hairstyle for female figures etc. **Hence, statement 1, 2 and 3 are correct.**

3. (a)

Explanation:

- Recently, the **Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC)** under the **Ministry of Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises** launched Project BOLD (Bamboo Oasis on Lands in Drought). **Hence, option (a) is correct.**
- The project aims to **boost the income of the tribal people** and **solve environmental concerns** such as **land desertification and land degradation** by creating bamboo-based green patches in drylands.

Project BOLD:

- The **first of its kind exercise** in India, project BOLD was launched on June 4, 2021, from the tribal village **Nichla Mandwa in Udaipur, Rajasthan.**
- Under it, 5000 saplings of special bamboo species – **Bambusa Tulda** and **Bambusa Polymorpha** from Assam were planted on approximately 16 acres of vacant arid Gram Panchayat land.
- With this, KVIC also created a **world record** of planting the highest number of bamboo saplings on a single day at one location.

- The initiative has been launched as part of KVIC's **"Khadi Bamboo Festival"** to celebrate 75 years of independence **"Azadi ka Amrit Mahotsav"**.

Benefits to rural tribal:

- Bamboo can be used for **multiple economic activities** such as for construction purposes, thus saving locals the cost of timber, bricks, and steel.
- Further, it provides **livelihood opportunities for locals and tribal men and women** in the form of handicrafts, making bamboo furniture, culinary items, paper, bags, handbags, textile, household items, to name a few.

Benefits to Environment:

- Bamboos are a diverse group of **evergreen perennial flowering plants**. It belongs to the subfamily of **Bambusoides** of the **grass family Poaceae**.
- In India, bamboo covers **13.96 million hectares** of area with **136 species**. Some of the important bamboos of commercial importance are **Bambusa Tulda**, **Bambusa Balcooa**, **Bambusa Cacharensis**, etc.
- Bamboos are great sources to **reduce land degradation, prevent land desertification, achieve sustainable development and solve food security** issues as bamboo shoots are also edible.
- By preventing land desertification, it can further solve **associated problems** like soil infertility, soil erosion, deforestation. Further, bamboo cultivation will also give rise to the **restoration of biodiversity** and **save the extinction** of species of animals by providing them habitat.
- According to studies, bamboo protects against harmful ultraviolet rays, reduces pollution, reduces up to 35% carbon dioxide in the climate, and delivers more oxygen.

Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC):

- It is a statutory body established under the Khadi and Village Industries Commission Act, 1956.
- It is charged with the planning, promotion, organisation and implementation of programmes for the development of Khadi and other village industries in the rural areas in coordination with other agencies engaged in rural development wherever necessary.

4. (a)

Explanation:

- With the objective of expanding his empire and maintain a strong army Akbar depended on mansabdari system.

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- Under this system, every officer was assigned a rank (**Mansab**). The lowest rank was 10 and the highest was 5000 for the nobles.
- The ranks were divided into two — **zat and sawar**. The word **zat** means **personal**. It fixed the personal status of a person and also the salary due to him. The sawar rank indicated the number of **cavalrymen (sawars)** a person was required to maintain.
- A person who was required to maintain as many **sawars** as his **zat** rank was placed in the first category of that rank; if he maintained half or more, then in the second category and if he maintained less, then in the third category. Thus, there were three categories in every rank (mansab).
- Provision was made that the contingents of the nobles should be mixed ones, that is drawn from all the groups — Mughal, Pathan, Hindustani and Rajput. Thus, Akbar tried to weaken the forces of tribalism and parochialism.
- The Mughal and Rajput nobles were allowed to have contingents exclusively of Mughals or Rajputs, but in the course of time, **mixed contingents** became the general rule. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- The categories were **NOT rigid**. Persons were generally appointed at a low mansab and gradually promoted, depending upon their merits and the favour of the emperor. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- A person could also be demoted as a mark of punishment. Thus, there was only one service including both armymen and civilians.
- People generally entered service at the lowest rung of the ladder and could hope to rise to the position of an amir.

5. (c)

Explanation:

- The communities of merchants were organised in groups known as **shreni or guilds** under the head called **sreshthi**.
- **Another type of mercantile group was called sartha**, which signified mobile or caravan trading corporation of interregional traders. The leader of such a guild was called **sarthavaha**.
- Like merchants, almost all craft vocations were also organised into guilds, each under a headman called **jetthaka/pamukkha**. **Hence, option (c) is correct.**

- These included weavers, corn dealers, bamboo workers, oil manufacturers, potters, etc. The guilds were associations of merchants and craftsmen following the same profession or dealing in the same commodity.
- They elected their head and framed their own rules regarding prices and quality to regulate their business on the basis of mutual goodwill. They also served as banks and received deposits from the public on a fixed rate of interest.

6. (b)

Explanation:

- Recently, the **National Institute of Animal Nutrition and Physiology, Bengaluru, an institute of Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR)** has developed an anti-methanogenic feed supplement called 'Harit Dhara'.
- 'Harit Dhara' when given to bovines and sheep, not only **cuts down their methane emissions by 17-20%** but also results in **higher milk production**. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- It has been made from **tannin-rich plant-based sources**. Tropical plants containing tannins, bitter and astringent chemical compounds, are known to suppress or remove protozoa from the rumen. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

Benefits:

- It **decreases the population of protozoa microbes in the rumen**, responsible for hydrogen production and making it available to the archaea (structure similar to bacteria) for reduction of CO₂ to methane.
- Fermentation after using this supplement will help produce more propionic acid, which provides **more energy for lactose (milk sugar) production and body weight gain**.
- An average lactating cow or buffalo in India emits around 200 litres of methane per day, while it is 85-95 litres for young growing heifers and 20-25 litres for adult sheep. **Feeding Harit Dhara can reduce these by a fifth.**

Methane production in cattle:

- Methane is produced by animals having rumen which is the first of the four stomachs where the cattle eat plant material, cellulose, fibre, starch and sugars. These get fermented or broken down by microorganisms before further digestion and nutrient absorption.



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- Carbohydrate fermentation leads to the production of CO₂ and hydrogen. These are used by microbes (Archaea) present in the rumen to produce methane.

Limiting methane emissions from cattle:

- Methane's global warming potential of 25 times of carbon dioxide (CO₂) over 100 years, makes it a more potent greenhouse gas.
- The 2019 Livestock Census showed India's cattle population at 193.46 million, along with 109.85 million buffaloes, 148.88 million goats and 74.26 million sheep.
 - Belching cattle, buffaloes, sheep and goats in India emit an estimated 9.25 million tonnes (mt) to 14.2 mt of methane annually, out of a global total of 90 mt-plus from livestock.
 - Being largely fed on agricultural residues i.e wheat/paddy straw and maize, sorghum or bajra stover – ruminants in India tend to produce 50-100% higher methane than their industrialised country counterparts that are given more easily fermentable/digestible concentrates, silages and green fodder.

7. (a)

Explanation:

Francois Bernier:

- François Bernier, a Frenchman, was a doctor, political philosopher and historian. He was in India for twelve years, from 1656 to 1668, and was closely associated with the Mughal court, as a physician to Prince Dara Shukoh, the eldest son of Emperor Shah Jahan.

Works of Francois Bernier:

- He dedicated his major writing to Louis XIV, the king of France. In virtually every instance Bernier described what he saw in India as a bleak situation in comparison to developments in Europe.
- Bernier's **Travels in the Mughal Empire** is marked by detailed observations, critical insights and reflection. He constantly compared Mughal India with contemporary Europe, generally emphasising the superiority of the latter.
- His representation of India works on the model of binary opposition, where India is presented as the inverse of Europe. He also ordered the perceived differences hierarchically, so that India appeared to be inferior to the western world.

- According to Bernier, one of the fundamental differences between Mughal India and Europe was the lack of private property in land in the former. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- He was a firm believer in the virtues of private property, and saw crown ownership of land as being harmful for both the state and its people.
- Bernier described Indian society as consisting of undifferentiated masses of impoverished people, subjugated by a small minority of a very rich and powerful ruling class.
- Between the poorest of the poor and the richest of the rich, there was no social group or class worth the name. Bernier confidently asserted: "There is no middle class in India." **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- Bernier felt that artisans had no incentive to improve the quality of their manufactures, since profits were appropriated by the state. Manufactures were, consequently, everywhere in decline. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

8. (d)

Explanation:

The history of Ashoka is reconstructed on the basis of his inscriptions. These inscriptions throw light not only on the reign of Ashoka, but also reveal his external and domestic policies, his views about dhamma, and the extent of his empire.

- There are a **total of 33 inscriptions**. These are primarily classified into **Major Rock Edicts, Minor Rock Edicts, Separate Rock Edicts, Major Pillar Edicts, and Minor Pillar Edicts**.
- The edicts of the earlier half of his reign were inscribed on conveniently located rock surfaces and were widely distributed throughout the empire, especially in the areas of public settlements where people can easily read these edicts, and are thus referred to as the Minor and Major Rock Edicts.
- On the other hand, pillar edicts were mostly inscribed in the latter parts of his reign and instead of rocks, were on well-polished sandstone monolithic pillars (quarried from the sites of Chunar, near Varanasi), each surmounted with a finely sculpted animal capital involving great technological expertise in cutting and engraving, and were largely confined to the Ganges plain (since they were transported by river).



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- Most of the Ashoka's inscriptions are about dhamma (Prakrit form of dharma, literally meaning the universal law or righteousness or social and religious order), and it was clearly inspired by the Buddhist upasaka dhamma (i.e., the Buddha's teaching for the laity), but it was not a mirror image of it.
- Twelfth Edict:** Mentions Ithijika Mahamatta (mahamattas in charge of women's welfare). It appeals for tolerance amongst sects, and for people to honour and understand the dhamma of others. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- Fifth Edict:** Appointment of Dhamma Mahamattas, a special cadre of officials entrusted to spread dhamma within the kingdom.
- The Saugaura Copper Plate Inscription and Mahasthan:** Inscription of Chandragupta Maurya; mentions relief measures adopted during famine in Magadha. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- Nigali Sagar Inscription (Nepal) to record the first enlargement of stupa (14 years after his consecration) and later Ashoka's visit to the site (20 years after his consecration).

9. (c)

Explanation:

- On July 5, 2021, the **Ministry of Education** launched the **National Initiative for Proficiency in Reading with Understanding and Numeracy (NIPUN) Bharat Scheme**.
- NIPUN Bharat **aims** to cover the learning needs of children in the age group of **3 to 9 years**. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- The **objective** of the NIPUN Bharat Mission is to create an enabling environment to ensure the universal acquisition of foundational literacy and numeracy, so that every child achieves the desired learning competencies in reading, writing and numeracy **by the end of Grade 3, by 2026-27**.
- NIPUN Bharat Mission has been launched under the aegis of the centrally sponsored scheme of **Samagra Shiksha**. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- The **focus area** of the scheme will be on -
 - providing access and retaining children in foundational years of schooling;
 - teacher capacity building;

- development of high quality and diversified Student and Teacher Resources/Learning Materials;
- and tracking the progress of each child in achieving learning outcomes.

- NIPUN Bharat will be implemented by the **Department of School Education and Literacy** and a **five-tier implementation mechanism** will be set up at the National- State- District- Block- School level in all States and UTs.
- The success of the scheme will **primarily depend on teachers**, so, there will be a special emphasis on the capacity building of teachers.
- A special package for foundational literacy and Numeracy (FLN) under NISHTHA (National Initiative for School Heads and Teachers Holistic Advancement) is being developed by NCERT.
 - Around 25 lakh teachers teaching at pre-primary to primary grade will be trained this year on FLN.
 - NISHTHA is a capacity building programme for "Improving Quality of School Education through Integrated Teacher Training".
- Under the Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan, a budget of **₹2,688.18 crores** has been allotted to the NIPUN Bharat mission for the financial year 2021-22.
- 'Samagra Shiksha' programme; which aims to treat school education holistically, from pre-school to Class XII; was launched subsuming three existing schemes namely
 - Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan (SSA)
 - Rashtriya Madhyamik Shiksha Abhiyan (RMSA) and
 - Teacher Education (TE)

10. (c)

Explanation:

- Ashoka pillars**, (usually made of chunar sandstone), as a symbol of the state, assumed a great significance in the entire Mauryan Empire.
- Objective:** The main objective was to disseminate the Buddhist ideology and court orders in the entire Mauryan empire.
- Language:** While most Ashoka pillar edicts were in Pali and Prakrit language, few were written in Greek or Aramaic language also.



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- **Architecture:** Mauryan pillars mainly comprise of four parts:
 - **Shaft:** A long shaft formed the base and was made up of a single piece of stone or monolith.
 - **Capital:** On top of shaft lay the capital, which was either lotus-shaped or bell-shaped.
 - **Abacus:** Above the capital, there was a circular or rectangular base known as the abacus.
 - **Capital Figure:** All the capital figures (usually animals like a bull, lion, elephant, etc) are vigorous and carved standing on a square or circular abacus.
- **Similarities with Persian (Achaemenian) Pillars:**
 - **Polished Stones and Motifs:** Both Maurya and Achaemenian pillars, used polished stones and have certain common sculpture motifs such as the lotus. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
 - **Proclamations:** Maurya's idea of inscribing proclamations (related to Buddhist teachings and court orders) on pillars has its origin in Persian pillars.
 - **Third Person:** Inscriptions of both empires begin in the third person and then move to the first person.
- **Differences with Persian (Achaemenian) Pillars:**
 - **The Capital Figure:** It was absent in Mauryan pillars of the Kumhrar hall whereas pillars at Persepolis have the elaborate capital figures.
 - **The Shape and Ornamentation:** The shape of Mauryan lotus is different from the Persian pillar.
 - **Pillar Surface:** Most of the Persian pillars have a fluted/ ridged surface while the Mauryan pillars have a smooth surface.
 - **Architectural Scheme:** The Achaemenid pillars were generally part of some larger architectural scheme, and bit complex and complicated, while the Ashokan pillars were simple and independent freestanding monuments.
 - **Shaft:** Unlike Mauryan shafts which are built of monolith (single piece of stone), Persian/Achaemenian shafts were built of separate segments of stones (aggregated one above the other).

Sculptures:

- Two of the most famous sculptures of the Mauryan period are those of Yaksha and Yakshi.
 - They were objects of worship related to all three religions – Jainism, Hinduism, and Buddhism.

- The earliest mention of yakshi can be found in Silappadikaram, a Tamil text.
- The torso of the nude male figure found at Lohanipur at Patna.
- Didargunj Yakshi was found at Didargunj village at Patna. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

11. (b)

Explanation:

Indian Council for Cultural Relations:

- The Indian Council for Cultural Relations (ICCR) was founded in 1950 by Maulana Abul Kalam Azad, independent India's first Education Minister. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- **Its objectives are:**
 - to actively participate in the formulation and implementation of policies and programmes pertaining to India's external cultural relations;
 - to foster and strengthen cultural relations and mutual understanding between India and other countries; **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
 - to promote cultural exchanges with other countries and people, and to develop relations with nations.
- The Indian Council for Cultural Relations (ICCR), is an **autonomous organisation** of the **Government of India**, involved in **India's external cultural relations (cultural diplomacy)**, through cultural exchange with other countries and their peoples.
- It was **founded in 1950 by Maulana Abul Kalam Azad**, independent India's first Education Minister.
- ICCR has been assigned the responsibility of facilitating the celebration of the **International Day of Yoga** by Indian Missions/Posts abroad since 2015.
- ICCR has instituted **several awards**, which are conferred upon the foreign nationals for their contributions in different fields, under its mandate of **promoting India's cultural relations**.

12. (a)

Explanation:

Tillari Conservation Reserve:

- The **Maharashtra government** recently declared the Tillari forest area in the Dodamarg and Sawantwadi range in the coastal Sindhudurg district as a conservation reserve area. **Hence, option (a) is correct.**



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- The total area of this forest reserve will be **29.53 square km** and it is located near the border of Maharashtra, Goa and Karnataka.
- Tillari is the **seventh wildlife corridor** in the state to be declared as a 'conservation reserve'.
- The 29 sq. km Reserve area connects **Mhadei sanctuary in Goa** and **Bhimgad in Karnataka**.
- Maharashtra has **62 conservation reserves**, of which 13 are in the western ghats.
- Tillari reserve has **semi-evergreen forests, tropical moist deciduous forests**, and a number of unique trees, butterflies, and flowers.
- Also, the region is known for tigers, elephants, leopards, bison, sambar deer, barking deer and chaushinga.

Conservation Reserves in India:

- Conservation reserves and community reserves are terms denoting **protected areas** of the country which typically act as **buffer zones to or connectors and migration corridors** between established national parks, wildlife sanctuaries and reserved and protected forests.
- Such areas are designated as conservation areas if they are **uninhabited and completely owned by the Government of India** but used for subsistence by communities and community areas if part of the lands is privately owned.
- These protected area categories were first introduced in the Wildlife (Protection) Amendment Act of 2002 – the amendment to the Wildlife Protection Act of 1972.
- These categories were added because of reduced protection in and around existing or proposed protected areas due to private ownership of land and land use.
- As of July 2019, there were **88 conservation reserves** and **127 community reserves** in India.

13. (a)

Explanation:

Key Term/ Concept	Meaning
Samanta	Refers to a king who has been defeated but his kingdom has been restored to him, with the condition that he will continue to accept the overlordship of the conquering king.

Erivirappattanas	Protected mercantile towns.
Vellalar	Cultivating groups
Kaniyudaiyar	Land owning farmers
Ulukudi	Tenant farmers.
Eccoru	The obligation of villagers to provide food for state officials.
Muttaiyal/Vetti/ Kudimai	The obligation of villagers to provide labour services to state officials.

Hence, pair 1 and 2 are correctly matched.

14. (c)

Explanation:

- Conjugal rights are rights created by marriage, i.e. the right of the husband or the wife to the society of the other spouse. The law recognises these rights— both in personal laws dealing with marriage, divorce etc and in criminal law requiring payment of maintenance and alimony to a spouse.
 - **Originating from Jewish law**, the provision for restitution of conjugal rights reached India and other common law countries through British Rule.
 - Section 9 of the Hindu Marriage Act, 1955, which deals with restitution of conjugal rights is being challenged now on the main grounds that it violates the fundamental right to privacy. The right to privacy is protected as an intrinsic part of the right to life and personal liberty under Article 21 and as a part of the freedoms guaranteed by Part III of the Constitution.
- Hence, statements 1 and 3 are correct while statement 2 is NOT correct.

15. (d)

Explanation:

- In July 2021, the Union Education Minister released the Report on **Unified District Information System for Education Plus (UDISE+) 2019-20** for School Education in India.

Key findings:

- 1. Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER):** At all levels of school education, GER has improved in 2019-20 compared to 2018-19.
- Upper Primary Level increased to 89.7% from 87.7%.
- Elementary Level increased to 97.8% from 96.1%.



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- Secondary Level increased to 77.9% from 76.9%.
- Higher Secondary Level increased to 51.4% from 50.1%.
Hence, statement 1 is correct.

II. Pupil-Teacher Ratio (PTR): It has improved at all levels of school education.

- In 2019-20, 96.87 lakh teachers were engaged in school education. This is higher by about 2.57 lakh compared to 2018-19. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

III. Total Students:

- In 2019-20, total students in school education from pre-primary to higher secondary have crossed 26.45 crores. This is higher by 42.3 lakh compared to 2018-19.

IV. Enrolment of Divyang Students:

- It has increased by 6.52% over 2018-19.

V. Enrolment of Girls:

- In 2019-20, enrolment of girls from primary to higher secondary is more than 12.08 crore. This is an increase of 14.08 lakh compared to 2018-19.

VI. Gender Parity Index (GPI):

- Between 2012-13 and 2019-20, the GPI at both Secondary and Higher Secondary levels have improved.
- Improvement of GPI has been most pronounced at the higher secondary level, which has gone up to 1.04 in 2019-20 from 0.97 in 2012-13.

United District Information System for Education Plus:

- It is one of the largest Management Information Systems in school education.
- It was launched in 2018-2019 to speed up data entry, reduce errors, improve data quality and ease its verification.
- It is an application to collect the school details about factors related to a school and its resources.
- It is an updated and improved version of UDISE, which was initiated in 2012-13 by the Ministry of Education.
- It covers more than 1.5 million schools, 8.5 million teachers and 250 million children.
- It helps measure the education parameters from classes 1 to 12 in government and private schools across India.
Hence, statement 3 is correct.

16. (d)

Explanation:

- During the Satavahana phase, many chaityas (sacred shrines) and viharas (monasteries) were cut out of the solid rock in the north-western Deccan or Maharashtra with great precision and skill.

- The Karle Chaitya in the western Deccan belongs to this era. The Nashik inscriptions of Nahapana and Gautamiputra Satakarni, which are on the walls of the three viharas, is another important architectural site belonging to this period.
- The official language of the Satavahanas was Prakrit, though the script was Brahmi. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**

King Kharavela (c. 1st century BCE)

- Probably belonged to The Mahamegha Vahana of Kalinga. Seems to have wrested Kalinga from Mauryans and founded an independent line of kings, the Chedis /Chetis of Kalinga.
- He is also known as Bhikshu-Raja, and he constructed a great palace known as the 'Palace of Victor'.
- Famous for the Hathigumpha Inscription, which is engraved on the Udayagiri hills near Bhubaneswar. It is the second inscription by Naganika after his Nanaghat inscription.
- Follower of Jainism and provided cave shelters for Jain monks in Udayagiri Hills. The Hathigumpha Inscription proves that Jainism entered Orissa and probably became the state religion within 100 years of the death of Mahavira. The inscription is so named because the image of an elephant is carved out of stone next to the boulder carrying the inscription. The inscription tells us that he was a follower of Jainism and had fought many successful battles against his neighbours. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

17. (a)

Explanation:

Nastaliq:

- Nastaliq was the art of writing or calligraphy, a fluid style with long horizontal strokes. It was Akbar's favourite style of calligraphy. **Hence, option (a) is correct.**
- Calligraphy, the art of handwriting, was considered a skill of great importance during Mughal rule. It was practised using different styles.
- It is written using a piece of trimmed reed with a tip of five to 10 mm called qalam, dipped in carbon ink (siyahi). The nib of the qalam is usually split in the middle to facilitate the absorption of ink.



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- Muhammad Husayn of Kashmir (c.1575-1605), was one of the finest calligraphers at Akbar's court. He was honoured with the title "zarrin qalam" (golden pen) in recognition of the perfectly proportioned curvature of his letters.

18. (d)

Explanation:

- Recently, it was reported that a **part of the Arctic's ice** called the "Last Ice Area", located north of Greenland, has melted before expected. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**

Last Ice Area:

- This region is located **north of Greenland and Ellesmere Island** in the **Canadian territory of Nunavut**.
- **World Wildlife Fund (WWF)-Canada** was believed to be the first to call this area the 'Last Ice Area'.
- Scientists had believed this area was strong enough to withstand global warming.
- The total disappearance of summer ice in the Arctic was estimated by the year 2040, however the 'Last Ice Area' was the exception. But, the first sign of change in LIA was observed in 2018. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

Importance:

- LIA is important because it was thought to be able to **help ice-dependent species as ice in the surrounding areas melted away**.
- The area is **used by polar bears** to hunt for seals who use ice to build dens for their offspring. **Walrus** too, use the surface of the ice for foraging. However, Penguins live on every continent in the **Southern Hemisphere**, from **Australia to Africa**. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- Sea ice is a highway for Inuit, who use it to travel and hunt. The term Inuit refers broadly to the Arctic indigenous population of Alaska, Canada, and Greenland.

Reasons behind melting:

- Scientists say that about 80 percent of thinning can be attributed to weather-related factors such as winds that break up and move the ice around.
- The remaining 20 percent can be attributed to the longer-term thinning of the ice due to global warming.

Arctic:

- It is a polar region located in the **northernmost part of Earth**.
- The Arctic consists of the Arctic Ocean, adjacent seas, and parts of Alaska (United States), Canada, Finland, Greenland (Denmark), Iceland, Norway, Russia, and Sweden.
- Land within the Arctic region has **seasonally varying snow and ice cover**.
- Since 2013, **India** has had **observer status in the Arctic Council**, which is the predominant inter-governmental forum for cooperation on the environment and development aspects of the Arctic.

19. (a)

Explanation:

- The **Ministry of External Affairs** has set up a New and Emerging Strategic Technologies (NEST) Division to engage in technology diplomacy and deal with the foreign policy and international legal aspects of new and emerging technologies (like 5G and artificial intelligence, etc.). It will enable more active participation of India in global forums in the area of technology governance and promoting our national interests. **Hence, option (a) is correct.**

20. (c)

Explanation:

- While the Palas and the Pratiharas were ruling over north India, the Deccan was being ruled by the Rashtrakutas, Probably the greatest Rashtrakuta rulers were Govinda III (793– 814) and Amoghavarsha (814–878).
- Amoghavarsha ruled for 64 years but by temperament, he preferred the pursuit of religion and literature to war. He was himself an author and is credited with writing the **first Kannada book on poetics**. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- He was a great builder and is said to have built the capital city Manyakheta (in present-day Karnataka).
- The Rashtrakuta rule in the Deccan thus lasted for almost two hundred years, till the end of the tenth century. The Rashtrakuta rulers were tolerant in their religious views and patronised not only Saivism and Vaishnavism but Jainism as well. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**



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- The famous rock-cut temple of Shiva at Ellora was built by one of the Rashtrakuta kings, Krishna I, in the ninth century. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

21. (b)

Explanation:

- **Telangana's** Rudreshwar Temple was recently given a **world heritage site tag** by UNESCO. The decision was taken at the **44th session** of the World Heritage Committee of UNESCO.
- The Rudreshwar temple was constructed in **1213 AD** during the reign of the **Kakatiya Empire** by **Recharla Rudra**, a general of **Kakatiya king Ganapati Deva**. **Hence, option (b) is correct.**
- It is also known as the **Ramappa temple**, after the **sculptor** who executed the work in the temple for 40 years.
- Ramappa is the **main Shiva temple** in a larger walled temple complex, which includes several smaller temples and structures. The presiding deity here is **Ramalingeswara Swamy**.
- The temple stands on a **6 feet high star-shaped platform** with walls, pillars and ceilings adorned with intricate carvings that attest to the unique skill of the Kakatiya sculptors.
- It is built of **sandstone** with decorated beams and pillars of carved granite and dolerite, with a **distinctive Vimana (inner sanctum)** made of lightweight **porous bricks**, also known as the **"floating bricks"**.
- The temple rests on a **foundation** that uses **sandbox technology**, with red sandstone and black basalt used to construct the main temple, and light bricks used for the gopuram or cupola.
- The temple is a living memory of the legend of the Kakatiyas who **brought a golden era to the Telugu speaking region** of South India.
- The Kakatiyas, after breaking free from Chalukyan overlordship, ruled much of central India, right up to the eastern seaboard, between the **12th and 14th centuries**.
- The temple stands as a testimony to the highest level of creative, artistic and engineering talents involving various experimentations in expressive art forms of the **Kakatiya period (1123-1323)**.

22. (b)

Explanation:

- The Pala rulers dominated eastern India from the middle of the eighth to the middle of the ninth century.
- The Pala rulers were great patrons of Buddhist learning and religion. The Nalanda university which had been famous all over the eastern world **was revived by Dharmapala**, and 200 villages were set apart for meeting its expenses. **He also founded the Vikramasila university** which became second only to Nalanda in fame. It was located on the top of a hill, on the banks of the Ganga in Magadha, amidst pleasant surroundings. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- The Palas built many viharas in which a large number of Buddhist monks lived.
- The Pala rulers also had close cultural relations with Tibet. The noted Buddhist scholars, Santarakshita and Dipankara (called Atisa), were invited to Tibet, and they introduced a new form of Buddhism there. As a result, many Tibetan Buddhists flocked to the universities of Nalanda and Vikramshila for study. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- Although the Palas were supporters of Buddhism, they also extended their patronage to Saivism and Vaishnavism. They gave grants to large numbers of brahmins from north India who flocked to Bengal. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- Their settlements helped in the extension of cultivation in the area, and the transformation of many pastoralists and food-gatherers to settle down to cultivation. The growing prosperity of Bengal helped in extending trade and cultural contacts with countries of Southeast Asia—Burma, Malaya, Java, Sumatra, etc.

23. (d)

Explanation:

Impact and Contribution of Contacts with Central Asia:

- **Pottery and Architecture:** They introduced the use of burnt bricks for flooring and that of tiles for both flooring and roofing. The period is marked by the construction of brick walls. Red pottery techniques, which were widely used in Central Asia, were replicated in the Indian Subcontinent too. The typical pottery of this period was red ware, both plain and polished with medium to fine fabric. The distinctive pots of this period are sprinklers and spouted channels.



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- **Trade and Agriculture:** Due to the establishment of intimate contacts between Central Asia and India, trade between the two regions also flourished. It is rather pertinent to note that even though it was **the IndoGreeks who introduced gold coins in India, it was the Kushanas** who were the first rulers in India to issue the gold coins on such a wide scale. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- **Military Knowledge and Equipments:** Being excellent horsemen themselves, the Shakas and the Kushanas introduced better cavalry and popularised the use of riding horses on a large scale.
- The Shakas and Kushanas introduced new dressing styles such as the turban, the tunic, trousers, heavy long coats and long boots, which were adopted not only by warrior classes but also by certain other sections of the society.
- **Administrative Organisation:** The Central Asian conquerors introduced new styles in administration. For instance, **the IndoGreeks introduced the practice of military governorship wherein they appointed military governors called strategos while the Kushanas introduced the 'Satrap' system of government, under which the empire was divided into numerous satrapis and each satrapi was placed under the rule of a satrap. Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

24. (c)

Explanation:

- The 'Right to Repair' movement traces its roots back to the very dawn of the **computer era in the 1950s.**
- The goal of the 'Right to Repair' movement is to get companies to make spare parts, tools and information on how to repair devices available to customers and repair shops to increase the lifespan of products and to keep them from ending up in landfills. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- In recent years, countries around the world have been attempting to pass effective 'right to repair' laws.
- The **Right to Repair electronics** refers to government legislation that is intended to allow consumers the ability to repair and modify their own consumer electronic devices, where otherwise the manufacturer of such devices require the consumer to use only their offered services. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

- The idea of 'Right to Repair' **originated from the USA** where the Motor Vehicle Owners' Right to Repair Act 2012, required the manufacturers to provide the necessary documents and information to allow anyone to repair their vehicles.

Benefits:

- This will help **boost business** for small repair shops, which are an important part of local economies.
- It will help **reduce** the vast mountain of **electrical waste (e-waste)** that piles up each year on the continent.
- It will save consumers' money.
- It will **contribute to circular economy** objectives by improving the life span, maintenance, re-use, upgrade, recyclability and waste handling of appliances.

Right to Repair movement around the World:

- In July 2021, the US President signed an executive order calling on the Federal Trade Commission to curb restrictions imposed by manufacturers that limit consumers' ability to repair their gadgets on their terms.
- The UK, too, introduced right-to-repair rules that should make it much easier to buy and repair daily-use gadgets such as TVs and washing machines.

25. (d)

Explanation:

Hindustani music is practiced in the northern parts of India. There are ten main styles of singing in Hindustani music like the 'Dhrupad', 'Dhamar', 'Hori', 'Khayal', 'Tappa', 'Chaturang', 'Ragasagaram', 'Tarana', 'Sargam' and 'Thumri'.

Dhrupad:

- It is one of the oldest and grandest forms of Hindustani classical music and finds mention even in Natyashastra (200 BC–200 AD). **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- The name is derived from 'dhruva' and 'pada,' which means that it denotes both verse form of the poetry and the style in which it is sung.
- Although Dhrupad consolidated its position as a classical form of music in the 13th century, it reached its zenith in the court of emperor Akbar. **He employed and patronised musical masters like Baba Gopal Das, Swami Haridas and Tansen, who was considered to be one of the Navaratna or nine gems of the Mughal court. Hence, statement 2 is correct.**



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- Dhruvad is essentially a poetic form that is incorporated into an extended presentation style that is marked by precise and overt elaboration of a raga.
- **Dhruvad includes use of sanskrit syllables and is of temple origin.** Dhruvad compositions usually have 4 to 5 stanzas and are performed by a duo. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

26. (c)

Explanation:

In the western India, many Buddhist caves dating back to the second century BCE onwards have been excavated. Mainly three architectural types were executed—

1. Apisidal vault-roof chaitya halls (found at Ajanta, Pitalkhora, Bhaja);
2. apisidal vault-roof pillarless hall (found at Thana-Nadsur in Maharashtra);
3. Flat-roofed quadrangular hall with a circular chamber at the back (found at Kondivite or Mahakali Caves in Maharashtra)

Hence, pair 1, 2 and 3 are correctly matched.

27. (b)

Explanation:

- The **G7 (Group of Seven) countries** proposed a 'Build Back Better World (B3W) initiative' at the recently concluded **47th G7 summit**. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- B3W is a values-driven, market-led, high-standard, and transparent infrastructure partnership to help **narrow the \$40+ trillion infrastructure gap in the developing world by 2035**. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- The B3W initiative aims to mobilize bilateral and multilateral as well as private-sector capital for investment in climate, health and health security, modernized digital technology, gender equity, and equality.
- The B3W is intended to be **global in scope** and to cover low- and middle-income countries.
- It is an **elaboration of the Blue Dot Network (BDN)** in which the US joined forces with Japan and Australia while remaining open to other partners' participation in efforts to support high-quality, private sector-led investments. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

- The B3W is "new" in that it has brought together the G7 countries and also extended invitations to join other democracies, including India, Australia, South Korea, and South Africa.

Group of Seven (G7):

- It is an intergovernmental organisation that was formed in **1975**.
- The bloc **meets annually** to discuss issues of common interest like global economic governance, international security and energy policy.
- The G7 countries are the **UK, Canada, France, Germany, Italy, Japan and the US**.
 - All the G7 countries and India are a part of the G20.
- The G7 does not have a formal constitution or a fixed headquarters.
- The decisions taken by leaders during annual summits are non-binding.
- The **UK hosted the 47th G7 Summit** as part of its 2021 G7 Presidency. It was held in **Carbis Bay, Cornwall** on 11-13 June 2021.

28. (a)

Explanation:

- When the Moon makes its elliptical orbit, its velocity varies and alters causing our perspective of the "light side" to appear at slightly different angles. This is what it calls the Moon's wobble or that is how it appears to our eyes. It is a cyclical shift in the moon's orbit, it is a regular swaying (Oscillation) in the moon's orbit.
 - The Moon wobbles impact the gravitational pull of the moon, and therefore, indirectly influences the ebb and flow of tides on the Earth. Each wobble cycle has the power to amplify and suppress the tides on Earth.
 1. During half of the Moon's orbit of 18.6 years, the Earth's regular tides are suppressed i.e. high tides are lower than normal and low tides higher than normal (Current situation).
 2. In the other half, the effect is reversed, which is called the tide-amplifying phase of the Moon.
- Recently, the National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA) has highlighted Moon's Wobble as a potential problem in the near future. **Hence, statements 1 and 2 are correct while statement 3 is NOT correct.**



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**29. (c)****Explanation:****Jajmani System:**

- It was a reciprocal social and economic arrangement between families of different castes within a village community in India, by which one family exclusively performs certain services for the other, such as ministering to the ritual or providing agricultural labour, in return for pay, protection, and employment security. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- These relations are supposed to continue from one generation to the next, and payment is normally made in the form of a fixed share in the harvest rather than in cash.
- The patron family itself can be the client of another whom it patronizes for certain services and by whom it is in turn patronized for other services. **The hereditary character allows for certain forms of bond labour, since it is the family obligation to serve its hereditary patrons.**

Advantages of Jajmani System:

1. **Security of Occupation:** Security of occupation is guaranteed in case of the jajmani system. Since this system is hereditary, the servicing caste is assured of his occupation. He knows that if he breaks his family occupation he shall not be able to earn his livelihood.
2. **Economic Security:** It provides economic security of servicing caste as the jajman looks after all of their needs. The kamins are assured of their economic security. In every monetary crisis the jajman helps the servicing caste. They extend all possible help to the kamins. So there is economic security in the jajmani system. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
3. **Close and Intimate Relationship:** There is a close and intimate relationship between the jajman and kamin. This relationship is not purely economical but it is sentimental and internal.

Disadvantages of Jajmani System:

1. **Source of Exploitation:** Jajmani system is exploitative. The agricultural castes, which are invariably upper castes, seek the services of the occupational castes, which were generally lower castes. The exploitation of lower castes continues under the garb of paternal ties.

2. **Feeling of Superiority and Inferiority:** In this system, the servicing caste are considered low whereas the jajmani are placed high. This has resulted in social inequality and feelings of superiority and inferiority.
3. **Impediment to Occupational and Social Mobility:** The Jajmani system has stood in the way of occupational mobility and resulted in lowering the economic standard of the servicing caste.
4. **Supported by Caste System:** Caste system is the basis of jajmani system. So this system suffers from all the evils of the caste system.

30. (c)**Explanation:**

- Recently, the **Andhra Pradesh government** has announced a **10% reservation** for the Kapu community and other Economically Weaker Sections (EWS) for appointments in the initial posts and services in the State government.
 - This reservation is extended per the Constitution (103rd Amendment) Act, 2019.

Kapu Community:

- The Kapus are **primarily an agrarian community-based** in the **Andhra-Telangana region**. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- It is believed that they migrated from the Gangetic plains, probably from Kampilya (near Ayodhya) thousands of years ago. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- They entered what is present-day Telangana and, after clearing the forests along the banks of the Godavari, settled down to farming.
- The Kapu community is demanding inclusion in the 'Backward Castes' category "like they were before independence".
- The first major protest for the inclusion of the Kapus in the 'Backward Castes' was held in 1993. A government order was then issued for their inclusion in 'Backward Castes'. However, it was not honoured.

103rd Constitutional Amendment Act:

- It introduced an economic reservation (10% quota) in jobs and admissions in educational institutes for Economically Weaker Sections (EWS) by amending Articles 15 and 16.
 - It inserted **Article 15 (6) and Article 16 (6)**.

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- It was enacted to promote the welfare of the poor not covered by the 50% reservation policy for SCs, STs and Socially and Educationally Backward Classes (SEBC).
- It enables both the Centre and the states to provide reservation to the EWS of society.

31. (a)

Explanation:

- The best known leather puppets in our country are those used in the Tholu Bomalatta of Andhra Pradesh. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- The origins of these puppets can be traced back to about 2000 BCE, as they are mentioned in the Mahabharata. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- Leather puppets are made out of the hides of goat, deer and buffalo. The skin is treated with herbs and oils, and then beaten till it becomes translucent.
- The different parts of the puppet's body are separately cut out of this skin. Gods and heroes are made the largest in size, because of their importance.
- The screen for the shadow puppet show is a bamboo box-like stage erected in the open air. In the rural areas, very often, oil lamps made of split coconut shells are used for lighting.
- The flickering light keeps the puppets in constant movement, and lends an air of magic to the show. Music forms an intrinsic part of the puppet show, and making musical instruments is a major craft occupation all over India.

32. (a)

Explanation:

- The three great 11th and 12th century Temples: the **Brihadisvara Temple at Thanjavur, the Brihadisvara Temple at Gangaikondacholisvaram and the Airavatesvara Temple at Darasuram** are part of UNESCO world heritage site list.
- The Temple of **Brihadishvara**, built by **Chola king Rajendra I**, was completed in 1035. The **Airavatesvara temple** complex, built by **Rajaraja II**, at Darasuram features a 24-m vimana and a stone image of Shiva. **Hence, statement 1 and 2 are correct.**
 - The temples are the symbol of the brilliant achievements of the Chola in architecture, sculpture, painting and bronze casting.

- **Meenakshi Amman Temple**, also known as Minakshi-Sundareshwara Temple, is one of the oldest and most important temples in India. It is located in the city of Madurai, Tamil Nadu. It was built during the **Pandya rule.**
- **The Shore Temple at Mamallapuram** is part of UNESCO world heritage site of the Group of Monuments at Mahabalipuram. It was built during the rule of **Pallava dynasty.**
- The **Virupaksha Temple** is located in Hampi in Karnataka, India. It is part of the Group of Monuments at Hampi, designated as a UNESCO World Heritage Site. The temple is dedicated to Virupaksha, a form of Shiva. The temple was built during the reign of the **Vijayanagara Empire.**

33. (c)

Explanation:

Right to be Forgotten:

- The 'right to be forgotten' is the right to have publicly available personal information removed from the internet, search, databases, websites or any other public platforms, once the personal information in question is no longer necessary, or relevant.
- The right to be forgotten falls **under the purview of an individual's right to privacy. Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- In 2017, the Right to Privacy was declared a **fundamental right** by the Supreme Court in its landmark verdict. As per the Supreme court, "the right to privacy is protected as an intrinsic part of the right to life and personal liberty under Article 21 and as a part of the freedoms guaranteed by Part III of the Constitution". **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- The right to be forgotten gained currency after the 2014 decision of the Court of Justice of the European Union ("CJEU") in the **Google Spain case.**
- It has been recognised as a **statutory right** in the European Union under the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) and has been upheld by several courts in the **United Kingdom, and in Europe.**

Personal Data Protection Bill:

- The Bill was introduced in Lok Sabha on December 11, 2019, and it aims to set out provisions meant for the protection of the personal data of individuals.



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- Clause 20 under Chapter V of this draft bill titled “Rights of Data Principal” mentions the “Right to be Forgotten.”
 - It states that the “**data principal (the person to whom the data is related)** shall have the right to restrict or prevent the continuing disclosure of his data by a data fiduciary”.
- Therefore, broadly, under the Right to be forgotten, users can de-link, limit, delete or correct the disclosure of their personal information held by data fiduciaries.
 - A **data fiduciary** means any person, including the State, a company, any juristic entity or any individual who alone or in conjunction with others determines the purpose and means of the processing of personal data.
- Even so, the sensitivity of the personal data and information cannot be determined independently by the person concerned but will be overseen by the Data Protection Authority (DPA).

34. (a)**Explanation:**

- Akbar introduced a number of social and educational reforms.
- He stopped sati, unless a woman herself with her own free will desired it. Widows of tender age who had not shared the bed with their husbands were not to be burnt at all.
- Widow remarriage was also legalised. Akbar was against anyone having more than one wife unless the first wife was barren. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- The age of marriage was raised to 14 for girls and 16 for boys.
- The sale of wines and spirits was restricted. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- Not all these steps were, however, successful. Akbar was living in an age of superstition and it seems that his social reforms had only limited success.
- Akbar also revised the educational syllabus, laying more emphasis on moral education and mathematics, and on secular subjects such as-agriculture, geometry-astronomy rules-of government, logic, history, etc. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- He also gave patronage to artists, poets, painters and musicians, so much so that his court became famous for the galaxy of renowned people known as the navaratna.

- Thus, under Akbar, the state became essentially secular, liberal and enlightened in social matters and a promoter of cultural integration.

35. (a)**Explanation:****Panchayats and headmen during Mughal Rule:**

- The village panchayat was **an assembly of elders**, usually important people of the village with hereditary rights over their property.
- In mixed-caste villages, **the panchayat was usually a heterogeneous body**. An oligarchy, the panchayat represented various castes and communities in the village.
- The decisions made by these panchayats were binding on the members.
- The panchayat was headed by a headman known as **muqaddam or mandal**.
- Sources suggest that the headman was chosen through the consensus of the village elders, and that this choice had to be ratified by the zamindar. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- Headmen held office as long as they enjoyed the confidence of the village elders, failing which they could be dismissed by them.
- The chief function of the headman was to supervise the preparation of village accounts, assisted by the accountant or patwari of the panchayat. The panchayat derived its funds from contributions made by individuals to a common financial pool. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- One important function of the panchayat was to ensure that caste boundaries among the various communities inhabiting the village were upheld.
- Panchayats also had the authority to levy fines and inflict more serious forms of punishment like expulsion from the community. The latter was a drastic step and was in most cases meted out for a limited period. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

36. (c)**Explanation:**

- Recently, Dholavira, a Harappan-era city, received the UNESCO world heritage site tag. UNESCO termed Dholavira as one of the most remarkable and well-preserved **urban settlements** in South Asia dating from the **3rd to mid-2nd millennium BCE**.

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- While it became the **fourth site from Gujarat** and **40th from India** to make the list, it is the **first site** of the ancient Indus Valley Civilisation (IVC) in India to get the tag.
- The IVC acropolis is located on a hillock near present-day Dholavira village in Kutch district, from which it gets its name.
- It was discovered in **1968** by archaeologist **Jagat Pati Joshi**.
- The site's excavation between 1990 and 2005 under **Ravindra Singh Bisht** uncovered the ancient city, which was a **commercial and manufacturing hub** for about 1,500 years before its decline and eventual ruin in 1500 BC.
- After Mohen-jo-Daro, Ganweriwala and Harappa in Pakistan and Rakhigarhi in Haryana of India, Dholavira is the **fifth largest metropolis of IVC**.
- The site has a fortified citadel, a middle town and a lower town with walls made of **sandstone or limestone instead of mud bricks** in many other Harappan sites. **Hence, option (c) is correct.**
- Unlike graves at other IVC sites, no mortal remains of humans have been discovered at Dholavira.
- Some of the unique features of the Dholavira site are-
 - a cascading series of water reservoirs
 - outer fortification
 - two multi-purpose grounds - one of which was used for festivities and the other as a marketplace
 - nine gates with unique designs
 - The funerary architecture featuring tumulus
 - hemispherical structures like the Buddhist Stupas

Rise and fall of Dholavira:

- Remains of a copper smelter indicate of Harappans, who lived in Dholavira, knew metallurgy.
- It is believed that traders of Dholavira used to source copper ore from present-day Rajasthan and Oman and UAE and export finished products.
- It was also a **hub of manufacturing jewellery** made of shells and semi-precious stones, like agate and used to export timber.
- Beads peculiar to the Harappan workmanship have been found in the royal graves of Mesopotamia, indicating Dholavira used to trade with the Mesopotamians.
- Its decline also coincided with the collapse of Mesopotamia, indicating the integration of economies.

- Harappans, who were maritime people, lost a huge market, affecting the local mining, manufacturing, marketing and export businesses once Mesopotamia fell.
- From 2000 BC, Dholavira entered a phase of **severe aridity due to climate change** and rivers like Saraswati drying up. Because of a drought-like situation, people started migrating toward the Ganges valley or towards south Gujarat and further beyond in Maharashtra.

37. (a)

Explanation:

- In Delhi Sultanate, after Wazir, the most important department of state was Diwan-i-arz or military department.
- The head of this department was called the Ariz-i-mumalik. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- The Ariz was not the commander in chief of the army. Since the Sultan himself commanded the forces, a separate Ariz department was first set up by Balban. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

38. (a)

Explanation:

- Chalukya emperor Jayasimha Siddharaja of Gujarat was devotee of Shiva. He built Rudra Mahakaal temple in Siddhpur and provided patronage to famous Jain scholar Hemchandra in his court. **Hence, statements 1 and 2 are correct.**
- Lakshman and Kandariya Mahadev Famous temple of Khajuraho was built by Chandel Rulers, rather than of Chalukya Rulers. Sun temple of Modhera was built by Chalukya ruler (Bheem Pratham). **Hence, statement 3 is NOT correct.**

39. (b)

Explanation:

- The **Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment** has formulated a scheme, namely Information-Monitoring, Evaluation and Social Audit (I-MESA) in FY 2021-22.
- Under this scheme, Social Audits are to be conducted **for all the schemes of the Department starting FY 2021-22.**
 - Social Audit is the audit of a scheme jointly by the Government and the people, especially by those who are affected by the scheme or its beneficiaries.



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- These social audits are done through **Social Audit Units (SAU)** of the States and the National Institute for Rural Development and Panchayati Raj.

Hence, option (b) is correct.

Benefits:

- Social audit is a powerful tool to promote **transparency, accountability and people's participation** in the schemes meant for them.
- It helps to **narrow gaps** between vision/goal and reality, between efficiency and effectiveness.

Status:

- Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA) was the **first Act to mandate social audit** by the Gram Sabha of all the projects taken up in the Gram Panchayat.
- Most states have set up an independent Social Audit Unit (SAU) and some have even begun to facilitate social audit in other programmes, including Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana, National Social Assistance Programme, Midday Meal Scheme and Public Distribution System.

40. (b)

Explanation:

- Shivaji was a great administrator. He laid the foundations of a sound system of administration. The king was the pivot of the government. He was assisted by a council of ministers called Ashtapradhan. However, each minister was directly responsible to Shivaji.
 - Peshwa – Finance and general administration. Later he became the prime minister.
 - Sar-i-Naubat or Senapati – Military commander, a honorary post.**
 - Amatya – Accountant General.
 - Waqenavis – Intelligence, posts and household affairs.
 - Sachiv – Correspondence.
 - Sumanta – Master of ceremonies.**
 - Nyayadish – Justice.
 - Panditarao – Charities and religious administration.**

Hence, option (b) is correct.

41. (a)

Explanation:

- The Digha Nikaya, Mahavastu and Milinda Panho are literary works produced between 200 B.C. – A.d. 200 this was the most flourishing period in the history of crafts and commerce in ancient India.
- The **Digha Nikaya** (Collection of Long Discourses) is a Buddhist scripture, the first of the five nikayas, or collections, in the Sutta Pitaka. In it we find mention of at least **two dozen occupations**.
- The **Mahāvastu** (Great Event or Great Story) is a text of the Lokottaravāda school of Early Buddhism. It describes itself as being a historical preface to the Buddhist monastic codes (vinaya). In it we find mention of **atleast 36 occupations**.
- Milinda-panha**, (Questions of Milinda) is lively dialogue on Buddhist doctrine with questions and dilemmas posed by **King Milinda** (Menander, Greek ruler of a large Indo-Greek empire in the late 2nd century B.C.) and answered by Nagasena, a senior monk. It enumerates 75 occupations 60 of which are connected to some kind of crafts.

Hence, option (a) is correct.

42. (a)

Explanation:

- Recently, Indian astronomers from Aryabhata Research Institute of Observational Sciences (ARIES), and the Indian Institute of Science, Bangalore, have for the first time given the theoretical explanation of the existence of a near-surface shear layer (NSSL) in the Sun. **Hence, statement 4 is NOT correct.**
 - ARIES is an autonomous institute under the Department of Science and Technology.

Near-Surface Shear Layer (NSSL):

- Apart from differentiation rotation between equator and poles, the helioseismology has revealed that the Sun has a Near-Surface Shear Layer (NSSL).
- The NSSL is the region very close to the visible solar surface, where there is a change in the rotation profile of the Sun. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- This layer exists very close to the solar surface, within which the angular velocity decreases rapidly with radius. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**



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- This NSSL is thought to play a significant role in defining the nature of large-scale convective patterns that drive the Sun's magnetism.

Findings of the Study:

- In their study, they have used an equation called the thermal wind balance equation.
- It explains how the slight difference in temperature between solar poles and equator, called thermal wind, is balanced by the centrifugal force appearing due to solar differential rotation.
- Understanding NSSL is crucial for the study of several solar phenomena like sunspot formation, solar cycle, and it will also help in understanding such phenomena in other stars. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

Differential Rotation of the Sun:

- It was long known that the Sun has Differential rotation, which means different parts of the Sun rotate at different speeds. The Sun rotates faster at the equator than at the poles.
- Over time, the Sun's differential rotation rates cause its magnetic field to become twisted and tangled.
 - The "tangles" in the magnetic field lines can produce very, very strong localized magnetic fields.
 - These localised magnetic fields on the surface of the Sun are active regions where sunspots occur.
 - Sunspots are areas that appear dark on the surface of the Sun (photosphere). They appear dark because they are cooler than other parts of the Sun's surface.
 - Further, these active regions often generate solar storms: solar flares and coronal mass ejections (CMEs).

43. (d)

Explanation:

- Gross Environment Product(GEP) was established back in 1997 by ecological economist Robert Costanza at the global level. It is considered as the product and service value that the ecosystem provides for human welfare and economic and social sustainable development, including provisioning, regulating and cultural ecosystem services. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- Ecosystems that can be measured include natural ecosystems such as forests, grassland, wetland, desert,

freshwater and ocean, and artificial systems that are based on natural processes like farmland, pastures, aquaculture farms and urban green land, etc. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

44. (d)

Explanation:

- The judicial system was far more developed under the Guptas (late 3rd century to mid 6th century) than in earlier times. For the first time civil and criminal law were clearly defined and demarcated. Theft and adultery came under criminal laws. Disputes regarding various types of properties came under civil law. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- The Gupta bureaucracy was not as elaborate as that of the Mauryas. The most important officer in the Gupta Empire was the Kumaramatyas. They were appointed by the kings in the home province and possibly paid in cash. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- Chinese traveler Fa-Hsien, visited India during the Gupta period. He visited many Buddhist sites in what are now Xinjiang, Pakistan, India, Nepal, Bangladesh and Sri Lanka between 399-412 CE. He informed us that Magadha was full of cities and its rich people supported Buddhism and gave charities. His writings gives an idea of economic life of people during Gupta period. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

45. (a)

Explanation:

- The latest edition of the **International Monetary Fund's (IMF)** World Economic Outlook has cut its 2021 growth forecast for India to 9.5% from 12.5% estimated earlier in April 2021. **Hence, statement 1 is correct and statement 3 is NOT correct.**
- While re-calibrating its forecast IMF considered two major factors which are **access to vaccines** and **risk of new COVID-19 variants**.

Major forecasts:

- The Indian economy is expected to grow by **9.5% in 2021** and **8.5% in 2022** (larger than the 6.9% it had projected in April). In 2020, India's economy witnessed an estimated contraction of 8%.



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- The IMF has cut its growth forecast because of the Covid-19 Second Wave that hit the recovery momentum, damaging consumer confidence and rural demand.
- Retained its global growth forecast at **6% for the year 2021**, and it is expected to grow at 4.9% for the year 2022. In 2020, the global economy contracted by 3.3%. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- Revised up its predictions of global trade volume growth by a sharp 130 bps for 2021 to 9.7% and 50 bps for 2022 to 7%. India is set to benefit from an expected rise in global trade prospects once its supply-side gains traction.

International Monetary Fund:

- The IMF was conceived in **July 1944** at the **United Nations Bretton Woods Conference** in New Hampshire, United States.
- It came into operation on **27th December 1945** and consists of **190 member countries**.
- The IMF's primary mission is to ensure the stability of the international monetary system—the system of exchange rates and international payments that enables countries and their citizens to transact with each other.
- The major reports published by the IMF are - **World Economic Outlook, Global Financial Stability Report, Fiscal Monitor, and External Sector Report**, in addition to a series of regional economic outlooks.

World Economic Outlook:

- It is a survey by the IMF that is usually **published twice a year** in **April and October**.
- It **analyzes and predicts global economic developments** during the near and medium-term.
- In response to the growing demand for more frequent forecast updates, the WEO Update is published in January and July between the two main WEO publications released usually in April and October.

46. (b)

Explanation:

- The secular decrees issued by Aurangzeb were known as **Zawabit**. **Hence, option (b) is correct.**
- A compendium of his decrees, and government rules and regulations were collected in a work called **Zawabit-i-Alamgiri**.
- Theoretically, the Zawabits supplemented the sharia. In practice, however, they sometimes modified the Sharia.

47. (b)

Explanation:

- The archaeological remains of the Harappa port-town of Lothal is located along the **Bhogava river**, a tributary of **Sabarmati**, in the **Gulf of Khambat**. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- The Harappan site of **Dholavira** is located on the Khadir Bet island. Dholavira, a prominent site of the Indus Valley Civilization, is located right on the **Tropic of Cancer**.
- Recently, the skeletal remains of a young man and woman, interred with his face turned towards her—has been excavated at the Harappan settlement at Rakhigarhi in Haryana, about 150 km from Delhi.
- This is the first couple's grave that archaeologists have confirmed in a Harappan cemetery.
- **Manda**, near **Jammu**, is the northernmost site of Indus Valley civilization. **Daimabad**, in Maharashtra, is the southernmost archaeological site of the Indus valley civilization. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- Alamgirpur, near Meerut, is the easternmost site of the Indus Valley Civilization. Sutkagan Dor (or Sutkagen Dor) is the westernmost known site of the Indus Valley Civilization. It is located about 480 km west of Karachi.

48. (b)

Explanation:

- Recently, the **Russian Space Agency Roscosmos** launched its **uncrewed Nauka laboratory module** to the International Space Station (ISS).
- It was launched from the **Baikonur Cosmodrome in Kazakhstan** using a **Proton rocket**.

Facts about Nauka:

- Nauka, meaning "**science**" in Russian, is the **biggest space laboratory** Russia has launched to date.
- It **replaced Pirs, a Russian module** on the ISS used as a docking port for spacecraft and as a door for cosmonauts to go out on spacewalks. **Hence, option (b) is correct.**
- Now, Nauka will serve as the **country's main research facility** on the space station.
- Nauka is 42 feet long and weighs 20 tonnes.
- It brought to the ISS another oxygen generator, a spare bed, another toilet, and a robotic cargo crane built by the European Space Agency (ESA).



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- On the ISS, Nauka was attached to the critical Zvezda module, which provides all of the space station's life support systems and serves as the structural and functional centre of the Russian Orbital Segment (ROS) - the Russian part of ISS.

International Space Station:

- A space station is essentially a large spacecraft that remains in **low-earth orbit** for extended periods.
- The ISS has been in space since **1998**.
- It is a result of cooperation between the **five participating space agencies** that run it: **NASA (United States), Roscosmos (Russia), JAXA (Japan), ESA (Europe), and CSA (Canada)**.
- The ISS circles the Earth in roughly **93 minutes, completing 15.5 orbits per day**.
- The ISS serves as a microgravity and space environment research laboratory in which scientific experiments are conducted in astrobiology, astronomy, meteorology, physics, and other fields.

49. (c)

Explanation:

- 'Ayam nijah paroveti ganana laghuchetasam udaracharitanam tu vasudhaiva kutumbhakam' | 'This is my own and that a stranger' – is the calculation of the narrow-minded For the magnanimous-hearts however, the entire earth is but a family' The original verse appears in Chapter 6 of Maha Upanishad. **Hence, option (c) is correct.**

50. (a)

Explanation:

Folk Music:

- **Baul:** It is not only a type of music but a **Bengali religious sect**. Their music represents a long heritage of preaching mysticism through songs in Bengal.
- **Wanawan:** It is the folk music from the State of **Kashmir**. It is especially sung during wedding ceremonies and is considered very auspicious.
- **Alha:** This form is from **Madhya Pradesh** and is a heroic ballad song with intricate words.
- **Panihari:** This form is from the State of Rajasthan and is thematically related to water.
- **Ovi:** This form of music is **from Maharashtra and Goa**. They are usually the songs of women i.e., they are sung by women during leisure time and when they are completing their household work.

- **Pai Song:** These songs are mostly from **Madhya Pradesh**. They are sung during the festivals.
 - **Maand:** This folk music is from the state of **Rajasthan**. It is said to have developed in the royal courts and hence is also recognised in the classical circles.
 - **Powada:** This is also a folk-type emerging from the state of **Maharashtra**. They are usually ballads sung for the heroes of the past like Shivaji.
 - **Khongjom Parva:** It is an important folk music from the state of **Manipur**.
 - **Bhavageethe:** These are emotional songs that are very popular amongst the masses in Karnataka and **Maharashtra**.
 - **Mando:** It is popular in **Goa** and is a unique blend of Indian and western musical traditions.
 - **Kolannalu or Kolattam:** It is popular in Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka and Tamil Nadu. It is similar to "Dandiya"
- Hence, option (a) is correct.**

51. (d)

Explanation:

- Recently, a group of astronomers detected a very short, powerful burst of high-energy radiation also known as **Gamma-Ray Bursts (GRBs)** that lasted for about a second.
- It was named **GRB 200826A** after the date it occurred, which is **26th August 2020**. It was detected by NASA's **Fermi Gamma-ray Space Telescope**. **Hence, option (d) is correct.**

GRB 200826A:

- It was a **sharp blast of high-energy emission** lasting just 0.65 seconds.
- After travelling for a very long period through the expanding universe, the signal had stretched out to about one second long when it was detected by Fermi's GRB Monitor.
- It had been racing toward Earth for nearly half the present age of the universe.
- It is considered to be the **shortest GRB till now** and it was caused by the death of a massive star.

Significance:

- It has helped to resolve the long-standing issues related to Gamma-Ray Bursts. Also, this study triggers to re-analyse all such known events to constrain number densities better.



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**Researchers:**

- The group involved in the detection of the burst **included Indian astronomers** from Aryabhata Research Institute of Observational Sciences (ARIES), the Inter-University Centre for Astronomy and Astrophysics, Pune (IUCAA), National Centre for Radio Astrophysics - Tata Institute of Fundamental Research, Pune (NCRA), and IIT Mumbai.

Gamma-Ray Bursts:

- These are the **most powerful events in the universe**, detectable across billions of light-years.
- Astronomers classify them as **long or short** based on whether the event lasts for more or less than two seconds.

Fermi Gamma-ray Space Telescope:

- Formerly called the **Gamma-ray Large Area Space Telescope (GLAST)**, it is a space observatory being used to perform gamma-ray astronomy observations from Low Earth Orbit.
- It was launched in **June 2008** and is named after **Enrico Fermi**, an Italian-American scientist who did pioneering work in high-energy physics.
- Fermi is an astrophysics and particle physics partnership, developed in collaboration with the US Department of Energy, along with important contributions from academic institutions and partners in France, Germany, Italy, Japan, Sweden, and the U.S.
- It maps the entire sky every three hours. It provides an important window into the most extreme phenomena of the universe, like GRBs, black-hole jets, and pulsars.

52. (c)**Explanation:****Chaukhandi Stupa:**

- The Chaukhandi Stupa is in Sarnath, near Varanasi. The stupa marks the spot where Buddha was reunited with the **pancha vargeeya bhikkhus**, his five companions who had previously deserted him at Rajgir. In Sarnath, Buddha gave his first sermon.
- Chaukhandi Stupa was originally constructed in the **5th Century AD**. It also finds mention in account of **Hiuen Tsang**, celebrated Chinese traveler of 7th century AD. Ashoka ruled India from 268 – 232 BCE. **Hence option (c) is correct.**

- There is an **octagonal structure** which stands atop a terraced rectangular plinth. It was built by Akbar in 1589 AD to commemorate his father Humayun's visit to the site.
- Recently, Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) has declared Chaukhandi Stupa as 'monument of national importance'.

53. (a)**Explanation:****Lingayat:**

- Lingayat was a movement in Karnataka, led by a Brahmana named Basavanna (1106-68) who was a minister in the court of a Kalachuri ruler. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- His followers were known as Virashaivas (heroes of Shiva) or Lingayats (wearers of the linga). They worship Shiva in his manifestation as a linga, and men usually wear a small linga in a silver case on a loop strung over the left shoulder.
- Lingayats believe that on death the devotee will be united with Shiva and will not return to this world. They also questioned the theory of rebirth. Therefore, they do not practise funerary rites such as cremation, prescribed in the Dharmashastras. Instead, they ceremonially bury their dead. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- The Lingayats challenged the idea of caste and the "pollution" attributed to certain groups by Brahmanas. The Lingayats also encouraged certain practices such as post-puberty marriage and remarriage of widows.
- The major source of Virashaiva tradition is derived from **vachanas** (literally, sayings) composed in Kannada by women and men who joined the movement. **Hence, statement 3 is NOT correct.**
- Ginan, on the other hand, is the mode of communication developed by Ismailis (a Shi'a sect). These included the ginan (derived from the Sanskrit jnana, meaning 'knowledge'), devotional poems in Punjabi, Multani, Sindhi, Kachchi, Hindi and Gujarati.

54. (d)**Explanation:**

- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) recently allowed non-bank payment system providers (PSPs), including prepaid payment instruments (PPI) issuers like mobile wallets, card networks and white label ATM operators to participate in the Centralised Processing System (CPS) as direct members.

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- Presently, only banks and select non-banks such as NABARD (National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development) and Exim Bank (Export-Import Bank of India) are allowed access to CPS owned by RBI – NEFT and RTGS.
- The RBI move that was first indicated in April 2021 means the following:
 - I. Allotment of a separate Indian Financial System Code (IFSC) to non-banks.
 - II. Opening a current account with the RBI in its core banking system (e-Kuber).
 - III. Maintaining a settlement account with the RBI.
 - IV. Membership of Indian Financial Network (INFNET).
 - V. Use of Structured Financial Messaging System (SFMS) to communicate with CPS.

Hence, option (d) is correct.

- Centralised Processing System (CPS) includes Real Time Gross Settlement and National Electronic Funds Transfer systems, owned and operated by the RBI.

Advantages:

- Direct access for non-banks to CPS lowers the overall risk in the payments ecosystem.
- It also brings advantages to non-banks like reduction in the cost of payments, minimising dependence on banks, reducing the time taken for completing payments.
- The risk of failure or delay in the execution of fund transfers can also be avoided when the transactions are directly initiated and processed by the non-bank entities.
- Non-bank entities shall transfer funds from their Current Account to RTGS Settlement Account and vice versa during the operating hours.

55. (b)

Explanation:

The seventh to ninth centuries saw the emergence of new religious movements, led by the **Nayanars (saints devoted to Shiva)** and **Alvars (saints devoted to Vishnu)**. They created hymns in praise of Vishnu and Shivas. Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.

Alvars and Nayanars came from all castes including those considered 'untouchable' like the **Pulaiyar and the Panars**. They were sharply critical of the Buddhists, Jains and brahmanical domination. Hence, statement 3 is correct.

There were 12 Alvars and originally 63 Nayanars. Among the 12 Alvars, **Andal was the only female saint**. She is also referred to as '**Meera of the South**'. Hence, statement 2 is correct.

56. (c)

Explanation:

Project I-STEM

- The Indian Science Technology and Engineering facilities Map (I-STEM) project aim to strengthen the R&D ecosystem of the country by connecting researchers with resources. Promoting technologies and scientific equipment development indigenously, and providing necessary supplies and support to researchers by enabling them access to existing publicly funded R&D facilities in the country through the I-STEM web portal.
- The portal will also provide a platform for the various City Knowledge and Innovation Clusters, especially by startups to enhance effective use of R&D infrastructure through leveraging collaboration and partnership built on a shared STI (Science Technology and Innovation) ecosystem. Hence, both statements 1 and 2 correct.

57. (b)

Explanation:

- Biotech-PRIDE (Promotion of Research and Innovation through Data Exchange) Guidelines were recently released by the Department of Biotechnology (DBT), Ministry of Science and Technology. Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.
- Along with the guidelines, a website of the **Indian Biological Data Centre (IBDC)** was also launched.

Biotech-PRIDE Guidelines:

- These guidelines envisage to bridge other existing biological datasets/data centres with the IBDC, which will be called **Bio-Grid**.
- This Bio-Grid will be a **National Repository** for biological knowledge, information and data. Also, Bio-Grid will be responsible for enabling its exchange, developing measures for safety, standards and quality for datasets and establishing detailed modalities for accessing data.
- These guidelines will be implemented through the Indian Biological Data Centre (IBDC). Hence, statement 2 is correct.



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- Currently, **India ranks 4th** amongst the top 20 countries contributing biological databases.

Need for Bio-Grid and its Advantages:

- With a large population of over **135 crores** and the **heterogeneous** character of the country, India needs its exclusive database for Indian research and solutions.
- This indigenous database will have a huge enabling mechanism for the exchange and adoption of data by young scientists and researchers for the benefit of Indian citizens.
- Sharing a wide range of large scale data advances the understanding of molecular and biological processes.
- This will contribute to human health, agriculture, animal husbandry, fundamental research and thus will extend to societal benefits.
- Advances in DNA sequencing with a steep drop in DNA sequencing cost have enabled government agencies to fund research towards the generation of large volumes of biological data in various sectors of Biosciences.

58. (a)

Explanation:

- Odishi dance is oldest classical dance which is based on **archaeological evidences**, this dance form originated into existence from **Devadasi's dance performing** in temple. Certain important characteristics of this dance are:
 - **Tribhanga Pose**
 - Creation of **complex geometrical** shapes by dancers from their body.
 - Use of **expressions and configurations** of poses expressing villages.
- While duet is characteristics of **Kathak dance** in which **competitive game is played** between tabla player and dancer. **Hence option (a) is correct.**

59. (d)

Explanation:

- Mainly three types of buildings have been found in the excavation sites in Indus Valley civilisation: dwelling houses, public buildings and public baths.
- The cities were divided into two parts - an upraised citadel and the lower part of the city.

- The upraised citadel in the western part was used for constructing buildings of large dimensions, such as **granaries**, administrative building, pillared halls and courtyard.
- In the lower part of the city, small one-roomed houses have been found which might have been used as quarters by the working-class people. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- Archaeologists have found numerous seals of different shapes and sizes all across the excavation sites.
- While most seals are square, it was found that triangular, rectangular and circular seals were also used. Steatite was the most common material used to make seals but agate, chert, copper, faience and terracotta seals have also been found.
- Most seals have inscriptions in a pictographic script that is yet to be deciphered.
- The script was written mostly from right to left, but, bi-directional writing style i.e. right to left on one line and left to right on another line has also been found. **Hence, statement 1 NOT correct.**
- The common animal motifs were unicorn, humped bull, rhinoceros, tiger, elephant, buffalo, bison, goat, markour, ibex, crocodile, etc.

60. (b)

Explanation:

- Recently, India has ranked tenth (**10th**) in Global Cyber security Index (GCI) 2020 by ITU (International Telecommunication Union) by moving up 37 places. India scored a total of 97.5 points from a possible maximum of 100 points, to make it to the tenth position worldwide in the GCI 2020. India secured the **fourth position in the Asia Pacific region**. **Hence, statement 3 is NOT correct.**
- India is emerging as a global IT superpower, **asserting its digital sovereignty with firm measures to safeguard data privacy and the online rights of citizens**. Based on performance on five parameters of cyber security, which are, Legal measures, technical measures, organisational measures, capacity development, cooperation. **National Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT-In) functions as the nodal agency for coordination of all cyber security efforts**, emergency responses, and crisis management. **Hence statements 1 and 2 are correct.**



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**61. (c)****Explanation:**

- The **Thakurani Jatra festival** started in **Berhampur, Ganjam district, Odisha**. Hence, pair 1 is **NOT correctly matched**.
- According to historians, the preparations for the festival start from Shivratri. The **Desibehera (barber)** goes to the Thakurani temple in the city and invites the Goddess for the festival. He also gets the **Shubha Khunti or holy mast** from the temple which is put in front of his house.
- Tharakhunji is the host to the quinquennial **festival of Khelchawa**. A festival, which celebrates the efforts of young boys becoming an adult.
- Tharakhunji is small hamlet situated in the **West Karbi Anglong district of Assam**. Situated around 70km from the city of Guwahati, Tharakhunji is one of many homes to the Hill Tiwas.
- The **festival of Khelchawa** is a completely **male dominated affair** in a matrilineal society. It is celebrated by the **Tiwas (Lalungs) of Assam and Meghalaya** in the month of April to mark the close of the harvest season. Hence, pair 2 is **correctly matched**.
- **Garia Puja** festival is celebrated in a traditional way by the people of **Tripura** and celebrated throughout the state with a lot of splendor and joy. Hence, pair 3 is **correctly matched**.
- It is a Puja done by the tribes of the state and is held on the seventh day of the month of April.
- This festival is celebrated as a harvest festival by the ethnic tribes and celebrations begin from last day of March-April.
- Children and youth play drums, sing and dance in front of the Lord Garia. They do this to please the deity. The Puja is mainly conducted by Jhumias.

62. (d)**Explanation:**

- We find information about the Janapadas and the Mahajanapadas from some of the Vedic and Buddhist texts. The Brahmanas refer to a category of Vedic texts which deal with the methods of performing Vedic rituals. Similarly, the Upanishads dealing with philosophical problems are also considered a part of the Vedic literature. These texts were composed from 800 B.C.

onwards. They refer to many Janapadas and Mahajanapadas and provide us with insights into the settlement of agricultural communities.

- Another category of sources providing us with information about this period is the texts composed by the Buddhists. The **Vinaya Pitaka** dealing with the rules of the order, the **Sutta Pitaka**, a collection of Buddha's sermons and the Abhidhamma Pitaka discussing problems of metaphysics tell us about the preachers, princes, rich, poor and towns and villages of that period.
- The **Jatakas** dealing with the stories of the previous births of the Buddha are part of the Sutta Pitaka. They give us graphic descriptions of contemporary society. These texts have clear references to various regions and geographical divisions. The archaeologists also contribute to our understanding of this period. Hence, option (d) is correct.

63. (c)**Explanation:**

- According to the International Renewable Energy Agency (IRENA), hydrogen will make up 12% of the energy mix by 2050. The agency also suggested that about 66% of this hydrogen used must come from water instead of natural gas. Hence, statement 2 is correct.
- Green hydrogen is produced by the electrolysis of water using renewable energy (like Solar, Wind) and has a lower carbon footprint. Hence, statement 1 is **NOT correct**.
- **Grey hydrogen and Blue hydrogen** are produced from natural gas while Brown hydrogen is produced from coal. Currently, less than 1% of the total hydrogen produced worldwide is green hydrogen. Hence, statement 3 is correct.

64. (b)**Explanation:**

- **Diwan-i-amir-i-kohi:** Muhammad bin Tughlaq (1325-1351) launched a scheme to extend and improve cultivation in the doab. Hence, pair 1 is **correctly matched**.
 - He set up a separate department called "diwan-i-amir-i-kohi".
- **Diwan-i-risalat:** Dealt with **religious matters**, pious

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foundation and stipends to deserving scholars and men of piety. It was presided by the Chief Sadr. **Hence, pair 2 is NOT correctly matched.**

- **Diwan-i-insha:** Dealt with the **state correspondence**. All the correspondence, formal or confidential, between the rulers and the sovereign of other states, and with his subordinate officials was dealt with by this department. **Hence, pair 3 is correctly matched.**
- **Diwan-i-arz:** Dealt with the **military department**. The head of this department was called the **arz-i-mamalik**. **Hence, pair 4 is NOT correctly matched.**

65. (a)

Explanation:

Vaisheshika School:

- The **Vaisheshika school** believes in the physicality of the Universe and is considered to be the realistic and objective philosophy that governs the universe.

- The **Kanada** who also wrote the basic text governing the Vaisheshika philosophy is often considered the founder of this school.
- They argue that everything in the universe was created by the **five main elements**: fire, air, water, earth and ether (sky). These material elements are also called **Dravya**.
- This school also developed the **atomic theory**, i.e. all material objects are made of atoms. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- On the subject of god, even though they argue for scientific thinking, they **believe in God** and consider him the **guiding principle**. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- They also believe that the laws of karma guide this universe, i.e. everything is based on the actions of human beings. The school believes in **pluralistic realism**.

School of Philosophy	Founder	Features
Sankhya	Kapila	● Believed in Dualism/Dvaitavada. ● This school doesn't believe in God. ● Purusha is consciousness and Prakriti is unconscious matter.
Yoga	Patanjali	● Salvation can be achieved by combining meditation and physical application. ● Yoga admits the existence of God as a teacher and guide. ● Yoga helps humans to control their mind, body and sensory organs.
Nyaya	Gautama	● Believe in the technique of "logical thinking" to achieve "salvation" ● The main teaching deals with the right knowledge of reality.
Vaisheshika	Kanada	● This school believes in pluralistic realism. ● Believed that the universe was created by fire, air, water, earth and ether(sky). ● They also developed in Atomic Theory.
Mimansa	Jaimini	● The art of reasoning, interpretation and application. ● Based on Vedas and also known as Purve or Karma Mimansa.
Vedanta	Badrayana	● This school believed the Brahma and Atma are indestructible. ● Believed in the theory of Karma. ● Believed in the theory of "Punarjanama or rebirth."

66. (c)

Explanation:

- **Guindy National Park** is **India's eighth-smallest national park** and **one of the very few national parks located inside a city**. It is located in the **heart of Chennai's metropolitan area**. It is one of the last

remnants of the tropical dry evergreen forests of the Coromandel Coast.

- In 1978 the small area, popularly known as Guindy Deer Park, was declared as a national park. About 22 acres of the Guindy National Park has been carved out into a park known as the Children's Park for ex-situ conservation. **Hence, option (c) is correct.**



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**Ex-situ and In-situ Conservation Methods**

- **Ex-situ conservation** is the conservation and maintenance of samples of living organisms outside their natural habitat.
 - Maintenance of Gene Banks, Seed Banks etc. comes under this method of conservation.
- **In-situ conservation** is the conservation of species in their natural habitats.
 - Maintenance of natural habitats in the form of wildlife sanctuaries, national parks etc. comes under this method of conservation.

67. (c)**Explanation:**

There are two well-known lists of Buddhas in the **Theravada Pali Canon**. The earlier texts identify seven buddhas, known as **The Seven Buddhas of Antiquity (Saptatathāgata)**. A later text, the Buddhavamsa, identifies a total of twenty-eight buddhas. **Hence, option (c) is correct.**

- The earliest strata of Pali Buddhist texts, especially in the first four Nikayas, only the following seven Buddhas, The Seven Buddhas of Antiquity (Saptatathāgata), are explicitly mentioned and named: **Vipassī; Sikhī; Vessabhū; Kakusandha; Koṇāgamana; Kassapa and Gautama.**
- Other texts identify the **future Buddha Maitreya**, who will appear on earth as a successor to Gautama Buddha. Thus, a total of twenty-nine buddhas are identified in traditional Pali texts.

68. (d)**Explanation:**

- The corpus of Sangam literature includes Tolkappiyam, Ettutogai, Pattuppattu, Pathinenkilkanakku, and the two epics— **Silappathigaram** and Manimegalai. **Tolkappiyam** authored by Tolkappiyar is the earliest of the Tamil literature. It is a work on **Tamil grammar** but it provides information on the political and socio-economic conditions of the Sangam period. **Hence, pair 1 is correct.**
- The Ettutogai or Eight Anthologies consist of eight works—Aingurunooru, Narrinai, Aganaooru, Purananooru, Kuruntogai, Kalittogai, Paripadaland Padirrupattu.

- The Pattuppattu or Ten Idylls consist of ten works—Thirumurugarruppadai, Porunararruppadai, Sirupanarruppadai, Perumpanarruppadai, Mullaippattu, Nedunalvada, Maduraikkanji, Kurinjippattu, Pattinappalai and Malaipadukadam. Both Ettutogai and Pattuppattu were divided into two main groups—Aham (love) and Puram (valour). **Tirukkural (Philosophy). Hence, pair 2 is correct.**
- Pathinenkilkanakku contains eighteen works mostly dealing with ethics and morals. The most important among them is Tirukkural authored by Thiruvalluvar. **Silappathigaram** written by Elango Adiga I, is a **love story** of Kovalan, Madhavi and kannaghi and Manimegalai by Sittalai Sattanar also provides valuable information on the Sangam polity and society. **Hence, pair 3 is correct.**

69. (c)**Explanation:**

- **LEAF (Lowering Emissions by Accelerating Forest Finance) Coalition was announced at the Leaders Summit on Climate, 2021.** The LEAF coalition will be one of the largest ever public-private efforts to **protect tropical forests** and intend to mobilize at least USD 1 billion in financing to countries committed to protecting their tropical forests.
- The goal of **net-zero emissions cannot be reached without bold leadership from the private sector** and commitment to leverage its scale, investment capacity and political power to build a more sustainable, resilient and equitable future.
- As it is a **public-private effort, thus also supported by transnational corporations (TNCs)** like Unilever plc, Amazon.com, Nestle, Airbnb etc. Tropical forests are massive carbon sinks and by investing in their protection, public and private players are likely to stock up on their carbon credits. **Hence, both statements 1 and 2 are correct.**

70. (a)**Explanation:****Monkey B Virus:**

- Monkey B virus is an alphaherpesvirus enzootic (endemic) in macaques and it was initially isolated in **1932**. Alpha-herpes-viruses are pathogens or **neuroinvasive viruses** that establish lifelong infections in the peripheral nervous system of humans and many other vertebrates. **Recently, China has reported the first human infection case with Monkey B virus (BV).**

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B virus is also commonly referred to as herpes B or herpes virus simiae or herpesvirus B.

- The infection can be transmitted via direct contact and exchange of bodily secretions of monkeys and has a fatality rate of **70% to 80%**. To date, **only one case has been documented of an infected person spreading the B virus to another person. B virus can survive for hours on surfaces, particularly when moist.** Hence statements 1 and 3 are correct while statement 2 is NOT correct.

71. (b)

Explanation:

- In Gupta empire, the king maintained close contact with the provincial administration through a class of officials called **Kumaramatyas and Ayuktas**. Provinces in the Gupta Empire were known as **Bhuktis**. Hence, **statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- Provincial governors were called **Uparikas** and were mostly chosen from among the princes. Bhuktis were subdivided into **Vishayas or districts**. They were governed by **Vishyapatis**. **Nagara Sreshtis** were the officers looking after the city administration. The villages in the district were under the control of **Gramikas**. Hence, **statement 2 is correct.**
- Fahien's account on the Gupta administration provides useful information. **He characterises the Gupta administration as mild and benevolent.** There were no restrictions on people's movements and they enjoyed a large degree of personal freedom.
- There was no state interference in the individual's life. Punishments were not severe. Imposing a fine was a common punishment. There was no spy system. The administration was so efficient that the roads were kept safe for travellers, and there was no fear of thieves. He mentioned that people were generally prosperous and the crimes were negligible.

72. (a)

Explanation:

Heat Dome:

- The phenomenon 'Heat Dome' begins when there is a **strong change (or gradient) in ocean temperatures**. In the process known as convection, the gradient causes more warm air, heated by the ocean surface, to rise over the ocean surface. Hence, **statement 1 is correct.**

- As prevailing winds move the hot air east, the northern shifts of the jet stream trap the air and move it toward land, where it sinks, resulting in heatwaves. This strong change in ocean temperature from the west to the east is the reason for the heat dome (HD). Hence, **statement 2 is correct.**
- They are more likely to form during La Niña years like 2021 when waters are cool in the eastern Pacific and warm in the western Pacific. Recently, the Pacific Northwest and some parts of Canada recorded temperatures around 47 degrees, causing a **"historic" heatwave**. This is a result of a phenomenon called "heat dome". Hence **statement 3 is NOT correct.**
- **El Nino and La Nina** are complex weather patterns resulting from variations in ocean temperatures in the Equatorial Pacific Region. They are opposite phases of what is known as the El Nino-Southern Oscillation (ENSO) cycle.
- **El Nino** is a climate pattern that describes the unusual warming of surface waters in the eastern tropical Pacific Ocean. It is the "warm phase" of a larger phenomenon called the El Nino-Southern Oscillation (ENSO). It occurs more frequently than La Nina.
- **La Nina**, the "cool phase" of ENSO, is a pattern that describes the unusual cooling of the tropical eastern Pacific.

73. (d)

Explanation:

- The **Vijayanagara period** was the **golden age of Telugu literature**. **Nachana Somanatha**, a court poet of Bukka I, produced a poetical work titled **Uttaraharivamsam**.
- **Krishnadevaraya** (1509-1529), the greatest of the Vijayanagara emperors, was a poet of great merit. His work **Amukta Malyada** is regarded as an excellent prabandha in **Telugu literature**
 - Eight Telugu literary luminaries, popularly known as **ashtadiggajas** adorned his court.
- **Tenali Ramakrishna**, the court jester, was an interesting figure of the **Krishnadevaraya's court**. His practical jokes on high-placed men of the time are recounted with pleasure even today. **Ramakrishna was the author of Panduranga Mahatmayam** which was considered one of the greatest poetical works of Telugu literature. Hence, **option (d) is correct.**



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**74. (b)****Explanation:****Vedanta School**

- Vedanta is made of two words- 'Veda' and 'ant', i.e. the end of the Vedas. This school **upholds the philosophies** of life as elaborated in the **Upanishads**. The philosophy propounds that Brahma is the reality of life and everything else is unreal or Maya.
- But the philosophy evolved in the **9th century AD** through the philosophical intervention of **Shankaracharya** who wrote commentaries on the Upanishads and the Bhagavad Gita. His changes led to the development of Advaita Vedanta.
- He considers **Brahma to be without any attributes**. He considers **Knowledge or jnana/gyan to be the main means of attaining salvation**. Hence, **statement 2 is correct**.
- Another major philosopher of this school was **Ramanujan** who wrote in the 12th century AD. His intervention led to some differences in Vedanta school. His philosophy is known as **Vishishtadvaita**.
- He considers **Brahma to possess certain attributes**.
- He considers **loving the faith and practicing devotion as the path to attain salvation**. Hence, **statement 1 is NOT correct**.

75. (c)**Explanation:**

- Recently, LIGO Scientific Collaboration (LSC) has made the discovery of gravitational waves from a pair of neutron star-black hole (NS-BH) mergers. Until now, the LIGO-Virgo Collaboration (LVC) was only able to observe collisions between pairs of black holes or neutron stars. The NS-BH merger is a hybrid collision.
- **Gravitational Waves:** It is an invisible ripple in space. Gravitational waves travel at the speed of light. **These waves squeeze and stretch anything in their path as they pass**.

Gravitational Waves are invisible ripples in space that form when:

- A star explodes in a supernova.
- Two big stars orbit each other.
- Two black holes merge.
- Neutron star-Black hole (NS-BH) merges

- As the two compact and massive bodies orbit around each other, they come closer, and finally merge, due to the energy lost in the form of gravitational waves. Hence, **both statements 1 and 2 are correct**.

76. (a)**Explanation:**

In the Delhi Sultanate period land reforms were introduced in the revenue administration. The lands were classified into the following three categories:

1. **Iqta land** – lands assigned to officials as iqtas instead of payment for their services.
2. **Khalisa land** – land under the direct control of the Sultan and the revenues collected were spent for the maintenance of the royal court and royal household. Hence, **option (a) is correct**.
3. **Inam land** – land assigned or granted to religious leaders or religious institutions.

77. (b)**Explanation:****Late Harappan Phase:**

- The Mature Harappan phase was followed by the Late Harappan phase, which was marked by the **decline of urban life** and the **diversification of agriculture**.
- The stylistic homogeneity of Harappan civilization disappeared and the post-Harappan stage was marked by **sharp stylistic diversity**.
- There was a complex interplay of change and continuity. Elements of urbanism like **seals, specialised crafts, cities, long distance trade**, and so on, declined but did not completely disappear.
- Some of the few urban centres surviving in the Late Harappan were **Kudwala in Cholistan, Bet Dwarka in Gujarat, and Daimabad**.
- A key development in this phase was the **beginning of double cropping**—wheat and barley were grown as winter crops and rice, millets, and sorghum were grown as summer crops. Hence, **statement 1 is NOT correct**.
- The rural settlements of this phase are primarily **Chalcolithic** in nature.
- The post-urban Harappans lived in villages, subsisting on agriculture, **stock-raising, hunting, and fishing**.
- In this period, painted Harappan pottery is replaced with less intricate designs and **painted grey ware**.



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(PGW). All Late Harappan sites lack human figurines. In comparison with Mature Harappan pottery, the pottery in the Late Harappan phase was less bright. **The pots were thicker and sturdier and many peculiar Harappan shapes like perforated jars, s-shaped jars disappeared. Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

- No object for measuring length is noticed. The period marks the end of the Harappan trade with West Asian centres, as lapis lazuli, chert, carnelian beads, copper and bronze vessels, are either absent or scarce as trade items.

78. (c)

Explanation:

Financial Stability Report:

- The Financial Stability Report (FSR) which is **published biannually** reflects the collective assessment of the Sub-Committee of the Financial Stability and Development Council (FSDC) - **headed by the Governor of RBI** on risks to financial stability and the resilience of the financial system. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- Recently, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) released the 23rd issue of its Financial Stability Report (FSR). COVID-19 Second-Wave has dented economic activity, but **monetary, regulatory and fiscal policy measures** have helped curtail the solvency risk of financial entities, **stabilise markets, and maintain financial stability. Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- The Gross Non-Performing Asset (GNPA) ratio of India's Scheduled Commercial Banks (SCBs) may climb by the end of 2021-22 to as much as 11.2% under a severe stress scenario, from 7.48% in March 2021. **Hence statement 3 is correct.**

79. (d)

Explanation:

- The administrative machinery or the Aryans in the Rig **Vedic period worked with the tribal chief**, because of his successful leadership in war.
- He was called **Rajan**. It is to be noted that in the Rig Vedic period which is also known as the early Vedic period, the **king's post was hereditary. Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- Several tribal assemblies such as the sabha, Samiti, vidatha, Gana are mentioned in the Rig Veda.

- These assemblies exercised deliberative, military and religious functions. Even **women attended the sabha and vidatha in Rig Vedic times. Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- But the two most important assemblies from the political point of view seem to have been the sabha and the Samiti.
- These two were so important that the kings showed eagerness to win their support.

80. (a)

Explanation:

Manipuri Dance:

- Manipuri dance form finds its mythological origin to the celestial dance of **Shiva and Parvati** in the valleys of Manipur along with the local '**Gandharvas**'.
- The dance form traces its origin to the festival of **Lai Haraoba** where many dances were performed. However, the dance gained prominence with the advent of Vaishnavism in the **15th century**. Then, **Krishna** became the **central theme** of this dance form. It is performed generally by females.
- In the modern times, **Raja Bhag Chandra of Manipur** in the 18th century tried to revive the Manipuri dance. **Rabindranth Tagore brought back the dance form into limelight when he introduced it in Santiniketan. Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

Some of the features of Manipuri dance are as follows:

- Manipuri dance is unique in its emphasis on devotion and not sensuality.
- The **faces are covered** with a thin veil and **facial expression is of lesser importance**, Hand gestures and gentle movement of feet are important. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- While the dance incorporates both Tandava and Lasya, emphasis is laid on the latter.
- **NagaBandha mudra**, in which the body is connected through curves in the shape of '8' is an important posture in Manipuri dance form.

81. (b)

Explanation:

- India is home to **9 species of Vulture** namely the Oriental white-backed, Long-billed, Slender-billed, Himalayan, Red-headed, Egyptian, Bearded, Cinereous and the Eurasian Griffon. **Bearded, Long-billed,**



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Slender-billed, Oriental white-backed are protected in Schedule-1 of the Wildlife Protection Act 1972. Rest are protected under 'Schedule IV'.

- Recently, the Ministry for Environment, Forests and Climate Change launched a **Vulture Action Plan 2020-25 for the conservation of vultures in the country**. The Vulture Safe Zone programme is being implemented at eight different places in the country where there were extant populations of vultures, including two in Uttar Pradesh. **Hence, option (b) is correct.**
- Recently, 150 vultures were seen in the **Valmiki Tiger Reserve (VTR)**, Bihar, which has prompted a vulture conservation plan in the protected region of VTR. It is located at the India-Nepal border in the West Champaran district of Bihar.

82. (b)

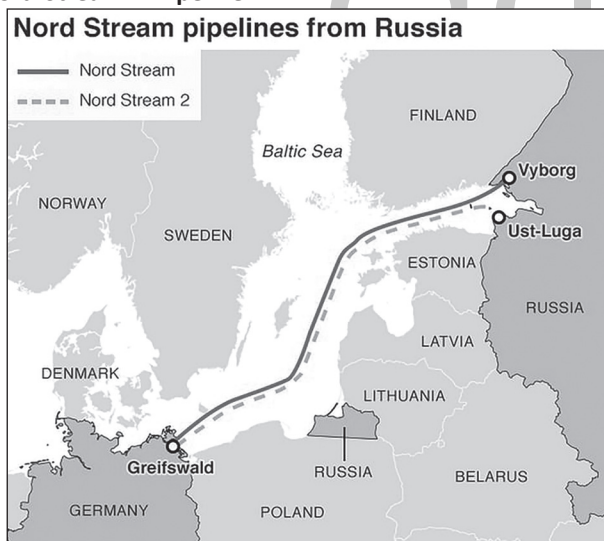
Explanation:

Krishnadevaraya was a great patron of literature and art and he was known as **Andhra Bhoja**. Eight eminent scholars known as **Ashtadiggajas** were at his royal court. **Allasani Peddanna** was the greatest and he was called **Andhrakavita Pitamaga**. Allasani Peddanna in his **Manucharitra** refers to the existence of four castes – **Brahmins, Kshatriyas, Vaisyas and Sudras** – in the Vijayanagar society. **Hence, option (b) is correct.**

83. (c)

Explanation:

Nord Stream 2 Pipeline:



- This is a **1,200-km pipeline that runs from Ust-Luga in Russia to Greifswald in Germany through the Baltic Sea**. It will carry 55 billion cubic meters of gas per year. Nord Stream 1 system is already completed and together with NS2P, it will supply 110 billion cubic meters of gas a year to Germany. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- There is an existing pipeline **between Russia and Europe through Ukraine**, once the NS2P project is completed it would bypass Ukraine and deprive it of a significant transit fee of around \$ 3 billion per year.
- It will **increase Europe's dependence on Russia for Natural Gas**, currently, EU (European Union) countries already rely on Russia for 40% of their gas needs. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct while statement 3 is correct.**

84. (a)

Explanation:

- The main sources of marine plastic are land-based, from urban and storm runoff, sewer overflows, beach visitors, inadequate waste disposal and management, industrial activities, construction and illegal dumping. Under the influence of solar UV radiation, wind, currents, and other natural factors, plastic fragments into small particles, termed **micro plastics (particles smaller than 5 mm) or nano plastics (particles smaller than 100 nm)** are examples of Marine plastic pollution. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- The GloLitter Partnerships Project is launched by the **International Maritime Organization (IMO)** and the **Food and Agriculture Organization** of the United Nations (FAO) and. initial funding from the Government of Norway. It aims to prevent and reduce marine plastic litter from shipping and fisheries. 30 countries including India have joined this global initiative to tackle marine litter. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

International Maritime Organization:

- The International Maritime Organization is a specialized **agency of the United Nations**.
- IMO is responsible for measures to improve the safety and security of international shipping and to prevent pollution from ships.



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- It is also involved in legal matters, including liability and compensation issues and the facilitation of international maritime traffic.
- It was established using a Convention adopted under the auspices of the United Nations in Geneva on 17 March 1948 and met for the first time in January 1959.
- It currently has 174 Member States.

85. (a)

Explanation:

- The **founder** of the Khalji dynasty was **Jalaluddin Khalji**.
- The introduction of paying salaries in cash to the soldiers led to price regulations popularly called as **Market Reforms**.
- Alauddin Khalji established **four separate markets in Delhi**, one for **grain**; another for **cloth, sugar, dried fruits, butter and oil**; a third for **horses, slaves and cattle**; and a fourth for **miscellaneous commodities**. Regulations were issued to fix the price of all commodities. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- Alauddin Khalji took important steps in the land revenue administration.
- He was the **first Sultan of Delhi** who ordered for the **measurement of land**.
- Even the big landlords could not escape from paying land tax.
- **Land revenue** was collected **in cash** in order to enable the Sultan to pay the soldiers in cash. His land revenue reforms provided a basis for the future reforms of Sher Shah and Akbar. **Hence, statement 3 is NOT correct.**
- His land revenue reforms provided a basis for the future reforms of Sher Shah and Akbar.
- He also built a famous gateway known as **Alai Darwaza** and constructed a new capital at Siri. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

86. (a)

Explanation:

The Aryans found it difficult to explain the coming of the rains, the appearance of the sun and the moon, and the existence of the rivers, mountains, and the like.

- They, therefore, personified these natural forces and looked upon them as living beings to whom they attributed human or animal attributes.

- The most important divinity in the Rig Veda is **Indra**, who is called **Purandara or destroyer of dwelling units**. Indra played the role of a warlord. He is considered to be the **rain god** and thought to be responsible for causing rainfall.
- The second position is held by **Agni (fire god)** to whom 200 hymns are devoted. Fire played a significant part in the life of primitive people because of its use in burning forests, cooking, and the like.
- In Vedic times, **Agni acted as a kind of intermediary between the gods, on the one hand, and the people, on the other.**
- The third important position is occupied by **Varuna** who **personified water**. Varuna was supposed to uphold the natural order and whatever happened in the world was thought to be the reflection of his desires.
- **Soma** was considered to be the **god of plants, and an intoxicating drink** is named after him. In the Rig Veda many hymns explain the methods of preparing this drink from plants that have not so far been satisfactorily identified. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- Many hymns are devoted to the **river Sarasvati**, who was considered an **important goddess**. Thus we have many deities who represent the different forces of nature in one form or another but are also assigned human activities. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- There are other women divinities too, such as **Aditi, and Usha** who represented the appearance of the dawn, but they were not prominent at the time of the Rig Veda. However, given the patriarchal society of the period, the male gods were far more important than the female.

87. (b)

Explanation:

- Recently, a separate 'Ministry of Co-operation' has been created by the Central Government for **realizing the vision of 'Sahakar se Samridhi'** (Prosperity through Cooperation) and to give a new push to the cooperative movement. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct**
- It will provide a separate administrative, legal and policy framework for strengthening the cooperative movement in the country. **It will help deepen Co-operatives as a true people-based movement reaching up to the grassroots.**
Hence, statement 2 is correct.



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Cooperatives in India

The **International Cooperative Alliance (ICA)** defines a **cooperative** as “an autonomous association of persons united voluntarily to meet their common economic, social, and cultural needs and aspirations through a jointly-owned and democratically-controlled enterprise.”

Constitutional Provisions:

- The **Constitution (97th Amendment) Act, 2011** added a new Part IXB right after Part IXA (Municipals) regarding the cooperatives working in India.
- The word “**cooperatives**” was added after “**unions and associations**” in **Article 19(1)(c)** under **Part III of the Constitution**.
- This enables all the citizens to **form cooperatives by giving it the status of the fundamental rights of citizens**.
- A new **Article 43B** was added in the **Directive Principles of State Policy (Part IV)** regarding the “promotion of cooperative societies”.

88. (a)

Explanation:

Bagru Block Printing

- ‘Titanwala Museum’ was inaugurated in Bagru village of **Rajasthan** that showcases the Chippa community’s (literally meaning people who stamp or print) Hand-block printing.
- Bagru printing is one of the traditional techniques of printing with natural colours followed by the chippas of a remote place of Rajasthan. **Hence, option (a) is correct.**
- Bagru printers use a technique called dabu in which a mixture of black clay, acacia gum, spoiled wheat flour, limestone is printed onto the fabric. The fabric can then be dyed and left in the sun to dry.

89. (b)

Explanation:

- **600BC– 300BC:** The principal **Shrautasutras** and some **Grihyasutras**
- **500 BC:** The **Sulvasutras** The **Digha Nikaya**
- **400 BC:** **Indica by Megasthenes** (This work is lost. The fragments in quotations by later writers such as Strabo, Arrian, and Diodoros survive, and their collection translated into English by McCrindle.)
- **150 BC:** Patanjali’s **Mahabhashya**
Hence, option (b) is correct.

90. (c)

Explanation:

Authorised Economic Operators:

- Authorised Economic Operators (AEO) is a programme (2007) under the aegis of the **World Customs Organization (WCO)** SAFE Framework of Standards to secure and facilitate global trade.
- It aims to enhance **international supply chain security** and facilitate the **movement of goods**. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- Under this, an entity engaged in international trade is **approved by WCO as compliant with supply chain security standards and granted AEO status**. **AEO is a voluntary programme. Hence statement 3 is correct while statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- The Indian AEO Programme was introduced as a pilot project in 2011. There is a three-tier AEO Status for Exporters and Importers. The three tiers are AEO T1, AEO T2, AEO T3, where AEO T3 is the highest level of accreditation.

The World Customs Organization (WCO):

- The World Customs Organization (WCO), established in **1952** as the **Customs Co-operation Council (CCC)** is an independent intergovernmental body whose mission is to enhance the effectiveness and efficiency of Customs administrations.
- Today, the WCO represents **183 Customs administrations** across the globe that collectively process approximately 98% of world trade. As the global centre of Customs expertise, the WCO is the only international organization with competence in Customs matters and can rightly call itself the voice of the international Customs community.

91. (b)

Explanation:

- Every region and period produced its own distinct style of images with its regional variations in iconography. The placement of an image in a temple is carefully planned:
 - **River goddesses (Ganga and Yamuna)** are usually found at the entrance of a garbhagriha in a Nagara temple.



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- **Dvarapalas (doorkeepers)** are usually found on the gateways or gopurams of **Dravida temples**. Hence, **statement 1 is NOT correct**.
- Similarly, mithunas (erotic images), navagrahas (the nine auspicious planets) and yakshas are also placed at entrances to guard them.
- **Kanheri Cave:**
 - The only **cave sculpture** of a boat is at the **Kanheri Caves in Mumbai**. It is located on an island called **Salsheti**, that is now connected to the mainland. Hence, **statement 2 is correct**.
 - The sculpture dates back to the 2nd Century AD and represents a **shipwreck with two men praying to the god Padmapani**, the first-ever indication of maritime voyage through sculpture.
 - More than 100 Buddhist caves popularly known as the Kanheri Caves. Kanheri, known as Krishnagiri or Kanhagiri in ancient inscription, literally means black mountain (Krishna means black and giri is mountain) and is mostly named after its black basaltic stone.
 - Spanning from the 1st century BC to 11th century AD, an era that saw the rise and decline of Buddhism, these caves present an insight into its evolution and also have the distinction of having the largest number of cave excavations from a single hill.

92. (c)

Explanation:

- The general weakness of Chalcolithic cultures is evident from the **burial of a large number of children** in western Maharashtra.
- Despite a food producing economy, **the rate of infant mortality was very high**. This might be attributed to **lack of nutrition, absence of medical knowledge, or outbreaks of epidemics**. In any event, the Chalcolithic social and economic pattern did not promote longevity. Hence, **statement 1 is correct**.
- The Neolithic age in the Indian subcontinent began around the seventh millennium BC. Some important crops, including wheat and barley, came to be cultivated in the subcontinent, and villages were established in this part of the world.

- People no longer depended on hunting, fishing, and gathering, with cultivation and cattle husbandry providing them with food. With their tools, they also built dwellings. With new means of food and shelter, they were on the threshold of civilization.
- The people of the Stone Age suffered from one great limitation. As they had to **depend almost entirely on tools and weapons made of stone**, they could not find settlements far away from the hilly areas. Hence, **statement 2 is correct**.
- They could settle only on the slopes of the hills in rock shelters and the hilly river valleys. Also, even with great effort, they were unable to produce more than they needed for bare subsistence.

93. (c)

Explanation:

- Recently, the Chhattisgarh government has proposed to reduce the area of **Lemru Elephant Reserve from 1,995 sq km to 450 sq km**. The reserve is located in the **Korba district of Chhattisgarh**. The reserve is aiming at **reducing human-animal conflict and destruction of property** in addition to providing a permanent habitat to the elephants.
 - The area proposed under the reserve is part of the **Hasdeo Aranya forests**, a very **diverse biozone** that is also rich in coal deposits. The biggest challenge in increasing the reserve area was that several coal mines would become unusable.
- Hence, **both statements 1 and 2 are correct**.

What are the reasons for the increased Man Animal Conflict (MAC)?

- **Habitat Loss: Only 5% of India's geographical area is in the protected area category**. This space is not enough to have a full-fledged habitat for wild animals.
- **A territorial animal like a male tiger needs an area of 60-100 sq km**. But the area allocated to an entire tiger reserve, like the Bor Tiger Reserve in Maharashtra, is around 140 sq km.
- The territorial animals do not have enough space within reserves and their prey does not have enough fodder to thrive on.
- This has forced the wild animals to move out and venture close to human habitation in search of food, resulting in MAC.

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**94. (d)****Explanation:****Official Language of Mughal Administration:**

The Mughals, while choosing the official language of India, had a few options like Arabic, Turkish, Persian or any Indian language. But the Mughals chose Persian language. Due to following reasons:

- The selection of the **Arabic language** might have shown some kind of **allegiance to the Caliph**. So this language was not selected.
- **Turkish language** was not as developed as Persian and was also completely **new to the Indians**.
 - Turkish was the mother tongue of Mughals. Babur wrote poetry and his memoirs in this language.
- The selection of any **Indian language** might have **diminished the symbol of the establishment** of a new rule in India.

Hence, statement 1, 2 and 3 are correct.

So in the light of the above mentioned options the Persian Language had a very favorable position.

- By the time the Mughals came to India, the people of the Indian sub-continent had already become **familiar with the Persian language and literature**. And this same language and civilization had almost each and every essential element of a good administration.
- So it compelled the Mughal rulers to encourage the **enrichment of Persian language** and literature for establishing a good administration to strengthen their stronghold over India.
- **It was spoken by the king, the royal household and the elite at court**. Further, it became the language of administration at all levels so that accountants, clerks and other functionaries also learnt it.

95. (c)**Explanation:****Phad Painting:**

- Phad is a type of **scroll painting**. The paintings depicting exploits of **local deities are often carried from place to place** and are accompanied by traditional singers, who narrate the theme depicted on the scrolls. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- It is mainly found in the **Bhilwara district of Rajasthan**. The main themes of the phad paintings depict the deities and their legends and the stories of erstwhile Maharajas. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

- They also depict the **heroic deeds of a heroic figure**, the **daily life of a peasant**, rural life, animals and birds, flora and fauna. These paintings are created using **bright colours and subtle colours**. The outlines of the paintings are first drawn in black and later filled with colours.
- Raw colours are used for these paintings. The unique features of phad paintings are the bold lines and a two-dimensional treatment of figures with the entire composition arranged in sections.
- The art of painting the phads is approximately **700 years old**. It is said that it originated in Shahpura, some 35 kms from Bhilwara in Rajasthan.
- The continuous royal patronage gave a decisive impetus to the art which has survived and flourished for generations.

96. (b)**Explanation:****India Industrial Land Bank:**

- The India Industrial Land Bank (IILB), a GIS-based portal, has seen a 30% increase in page views each month since April 2021. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- It aims to provide information on **available land for prospective investors** looking at setting up units in the Country. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- **Department for Promotion of Industry & Internal Trade (DPIIT) has developed IILB portal**, a GIS-enabled database of industrial areas/clusters across the country to adopt a committed approach towards resource optimization, industrial up-gradation, and sustainability. **Hence, statement 3 is NOT correct.**
- The portal serves as a one-stop solution to the free and easy accessibility of all industrial information including availability of raw material, agriculture, horticulture, minerals, natural resources; distance from key logistic nodes; layers of terrain and urban infrastructure.

The Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT):

- The Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) was established in the year **1995** and was reconstituted in the year 2000 with the merger of the Department of Industrial Development. Earlier, separate Ministries of Small Scale Industries & Agro and Rural Industries (SSI &ARI) and Heavy Industries



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and Public Enterprises (HI&PE) were created in October 1999. The department was earlier called the **Department of Industrial Policy & Promotion** and was renamed the **DPIIT in January 2019**.

- The Department handles matters related to **Protection of Intellectual Property Rights (IPR)** and administers six Acts related to IPRs. The Department also **handles matters related to Foreign Direct Investment (FDI)** and undertakes the promotion of investment for the industrial development of the country. There are five territorial divisions for international cooperation and industrial promotion handling matters emanating from the Americas, Europe, CIS countries, Africa and the Middle East, and Asia and Oceania.
- The Department is responsible for promotion and development of sectors related to cables, Light Engineering Industries, Light Industries, Light Electrical Engineering Industries, Paper and Newsprint, Tyres and Tubes, Salt, Cement, Ceramics, Tiles and Glass, Leather Goods Soaps and detergents and Industries not covered by other Ministries/Departments.

97. (a)

Explanation:

Gandhara school of Art:

- Stylistically, the **Gandhara school of sculpture** represents **Greco-Roman Buddhist art**. The important features of this art form are that the sculptors are extremely fine and realistic. The Buddha and Bodhisattva sculptures display quite a sophisticated iconography in an advanced style.
- The Gandhara sculptures suggest the earliest representations of the Buddha. Many plaques which were the parts of stupa earlier show the **scenes of the birth of Buddha, his enlightenment, sermon at the deer park, his death and others**.
- In Gandhara School of Art, the **seated Buddha is shown cross-legged** in the traditional Indian way (realistic). However, the **Mathura School of Art depicts the ideal yogi posture**, namely the **lotus feet and the meditative gaze**. Mathura artists rejected the Greco-Roman realistic features and chose naturalistic features to create the sculptures.
Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.
- Another typical feature of the **Gandhara Art is the**

rich carving, elaborate ornamentation and complex symbolism. The **aesthetic quality** of the **Gandhara Buddhas is different** from that of the **Mathura Buddhas**. The Buddha and Bodhisattva figures resemble the **Greek God Apollo** with broad shoulders, **a halo around the head** and these resemble a powerful hero rather than a yogi. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

- **The dress of the Buddha is depicted as realistic with many folds**. The physical features such as **muscles, nails, hair have been done with great detail**. The **drapery, heavy ornamentation and moustaches** featured on the images of Buddha and Bodhisattva were far from the Indian idealism. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

98. (b)

Explanation:

Antimicrobial Resistance (AMR):

- Antimicrobial resistance is the resistance acquired by any microorganism (bacteria, viruses, fungi, parasite, etc.) against antimicrobial drugs (such as antibiotics, antifungals, antivirals, antimalarials, and anthelmintics) that are used to treat infections. As a result, standard treatments become ineffective, infections persist and may spread to others. Microorganisms that develop antimicrobial resistance are sometimes referred to as "superbugs". **Hence statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- Reasons for the Spread of AMR include misuse of antimicrobials in medicine and inappropriate use in agriculture. Contamination around pharmaceutical manufacturing sites where untreated waste releases large amounts of active antimicrobials into the environment. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

99. (a)

Explanation:

Kisan-Sarthi Platform:

- Recently, the Kisan Sarthi platform was jointly launched by the Union Minister for Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare and the Union Minister of Electronics & Information Technology. It is a digital platform to facilitate farmers to get the 'right information at right time' in their desired language.
- It will help farmers to interact and avail personalised advisories on agriculture and allied areas directly from



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the respective scientists of Krishi Vigyan Kendra (KVKs). Kisan Sarthi platform was launched on the 93rd foundation day of the Indian Council of Agriculture Research (ICAR).

Hence, statement 1 is correct while statement 2 is NOT correct.

100. (d)

Explanation:

The founder of the Chola Empire was **Vijayalaya**. He captured **Tanjore** from Muttaraiyars in 815 A.D. and built a temple for Durga.

Rajaraja I

- The extent of the Chola empire under **Rajaraja I** included the **Pandya, Chera, Madurai**. He also invaded

Sri Lanka and annexed its northern part to his empire. Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.

- He completed the construction of the famous **Rajarajeswara temple** or **Brihadeeswara temple** at Tanjore in 1010 A.D.

Rajendra I

- He marched across Kalinga to Bengal the Chola Armies crossed the river Ganga, and defeated two local kings. This expedition took the same route which the great conquered Samudragupta had followed. Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.
- In Chola Dynasty, Province called “Mandalam” and districts called “Valanadu/ Nadu”.
- Guilds were used to trade with South-East Asia.



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